SABEEL INSTITUTE

سبيل

Class Recordings

User Manual

App version 0.7.0 · October 2026

Welcome! This guide explains everything the Sabeel Class Recordings app can do — from listening to your first class to taking attendance and tracking who has caught up. It is organized by role: **students** start with Part 1; **staff** (managers and admins) add Part 2; **admins** add Part 3. Part 4 is a quick "How do I…?" index you can skim any time.

The app works the same on the website (https://sabeel-class-recordings.web.app) and the Android app — same account, same data, live everywhere. Every screen in this guide is shown twice: once **on a phone** and once **on a computer**, so you can recognize it wherever you are. Both are captures of the website, at a phone's width and a laptop's; the Android app draws the same screens, minus the one thing Section 2.11 calls out.

The big picture (2 minutes)

1. **Recordings are audio only.** Each one is the sound of one class meeting — no video. They stream in the app; nothing is downloaded to fill up your phone, and each play link is freshly issued and expires, so recordings stay inside the app.
2. **The app is for catching up on a class you were excused from.** Staff take **attendance** for each meeting. If they mark you **excused**, that meeting's recording opens to you and becomes *required listening* — it appears on your **Listening** screen with a date to listen by, and closes again after it. If you were **present**, you don't need it. If you were **absent** without being excused, it isn't opened to you. Being excused is the whole of it.
3. **You mark your own listening complete.** The app saves your place and shows how much you've heard, but *you* decide when you're done — it is on your honor. (The one rule: you have to have pressed play at least once.)
4. **Staff can see who has caught up.** For every recording there is a ledger: of the students who were excused, who has finished and who missed the date — plus, for the record, who was present and who was absent. Staff can export it and, with a written reason, mark a completion on someone's behalf.
5. **Everything important is written down.** Approvals, overrides and edits are recorded in an audit history that admins can review.

That's the whole system. Everything below is detail.

Finding your way around

The app has a **bar along the bottom** on a phone and a **narrow strip of icons down the left** on a computer. It is the same set of places either way, and it is always there — so wherever you are, you are one tap from anywhere else.

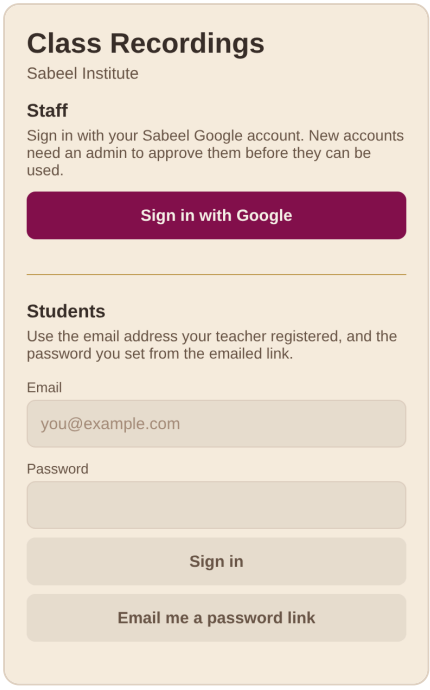
Students have **Listening**, **Classes** and **More**. Staff have **Today**, **Courses**, **Library**, **People** and **More**.

More holds the things you need occasionally rather than daily: notification settings, the privacy policy, signing out, and — for students — changing your password. Admins also reach the audit history there.

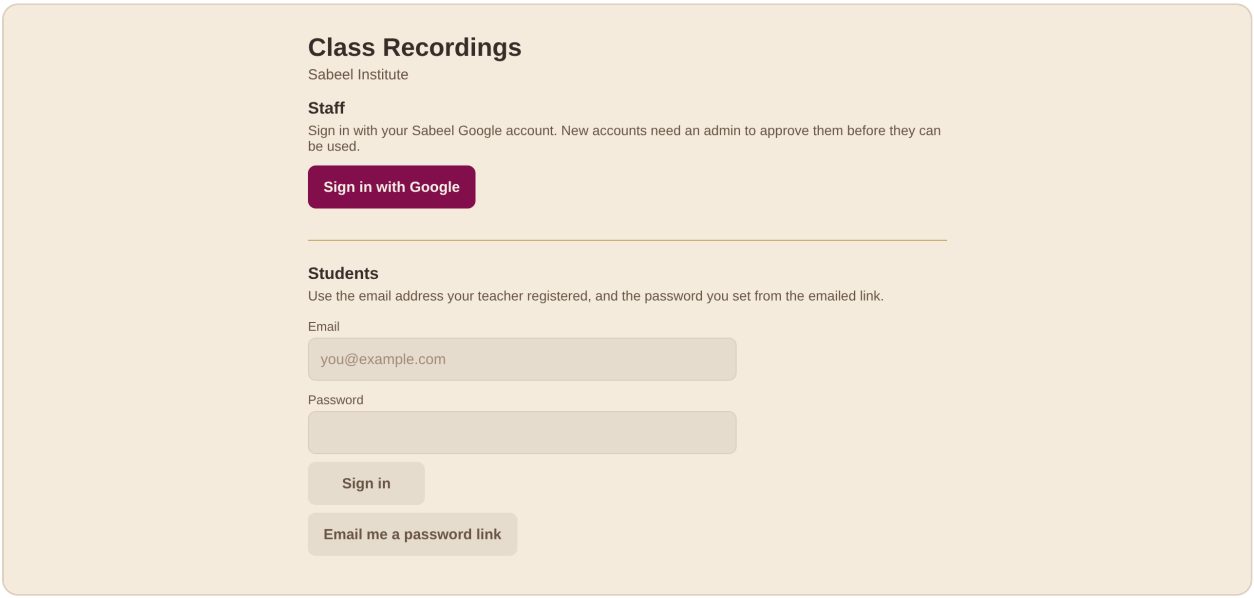
When something is playing, a slim bar shows what it is with a play/pause button — above the tabs on a phone, along the foot of the window on a computer. You can move around the app and it keeps playing; tap the bar to go back to the full player.

Part 1 — For students

1.1 Signing in



On a phone



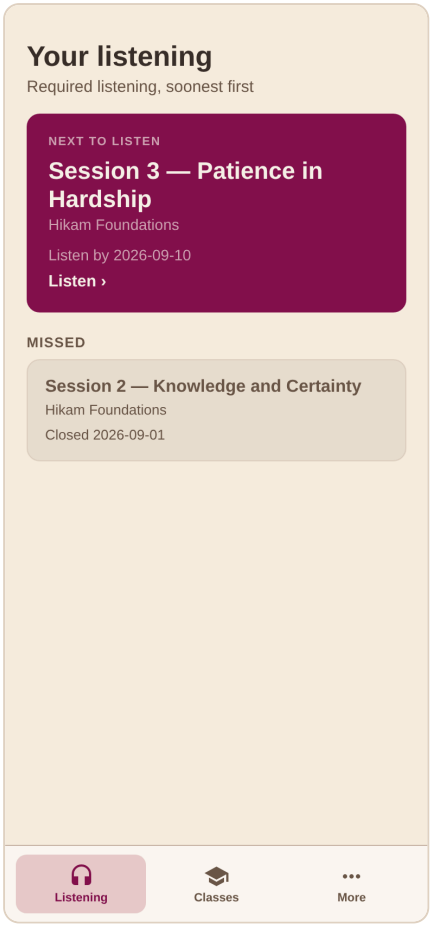
On a computer

Open the app or the website. Under **Students**, enter the **email address your teacher registered** and your password, then tap **Sign in**.

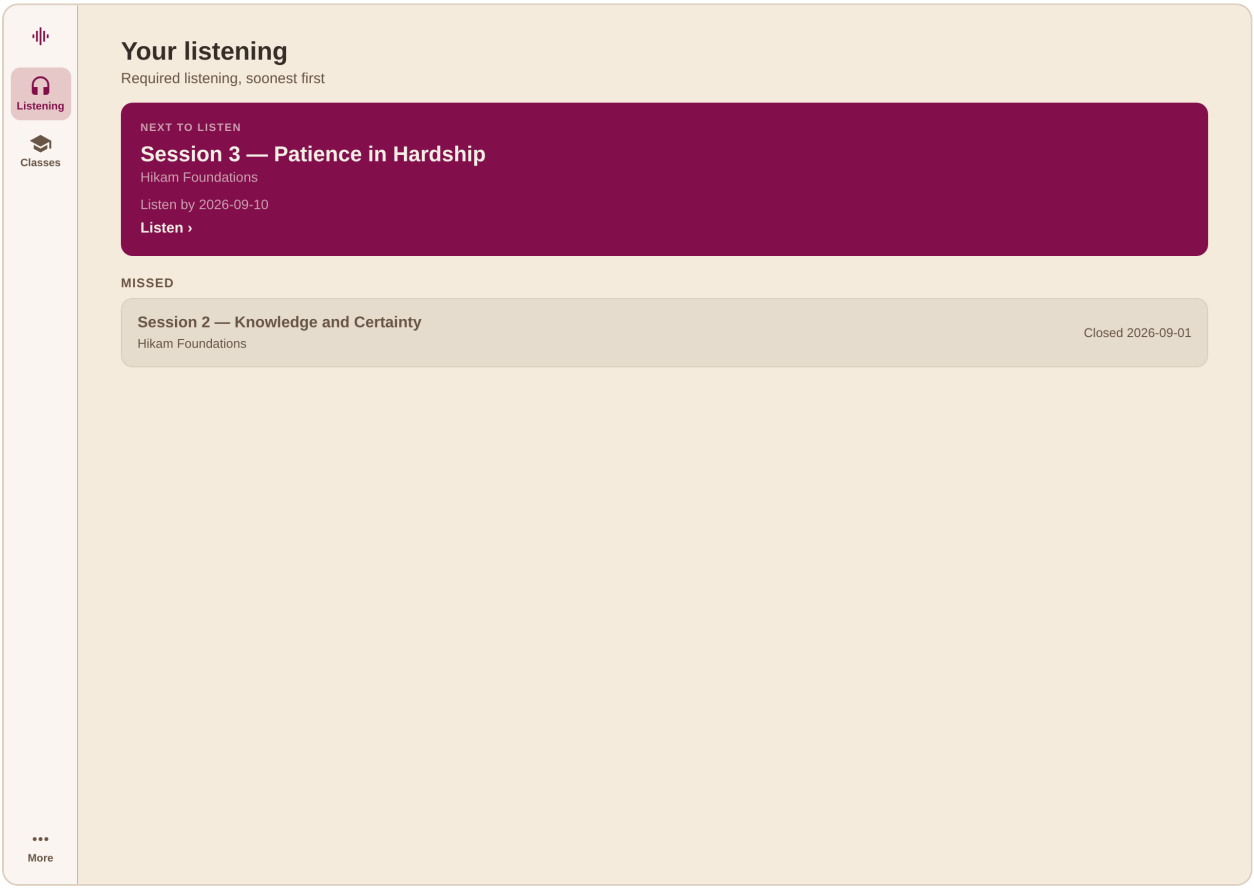
Your first password comes from an email. When your teacher creates your account, the app sends you a “set your password” link — open it, choose a password, and you’re ready. If you never received it or the link has expired, tap **Email me a password link** on this screen to get a fresh one.

The **Staff** section at the top is only for teachers and administrators — you don’t need it.

1.2 Your listening list



On a phone



On a computer

This is **Your listening**, the first thing the app opens on. It holds every recording that has been opened to you, most urgent first.

A recording is opened to you when your teacher marks you *excused* for that class. That is the whole rule. If you were there, you don't need it; if you missed a class without being excused, it isn't opened to you. So this one list is both what you *may* listen to and what you *need* to listen to — there is no separate archive to go hunting through.

The one to listen to next is at the top, in full. It is the most urgent recording still open to you, shown as a large card so there is no hunting on the screen you open most. Everything else sits underneath it, grouped so nothing slips past you:

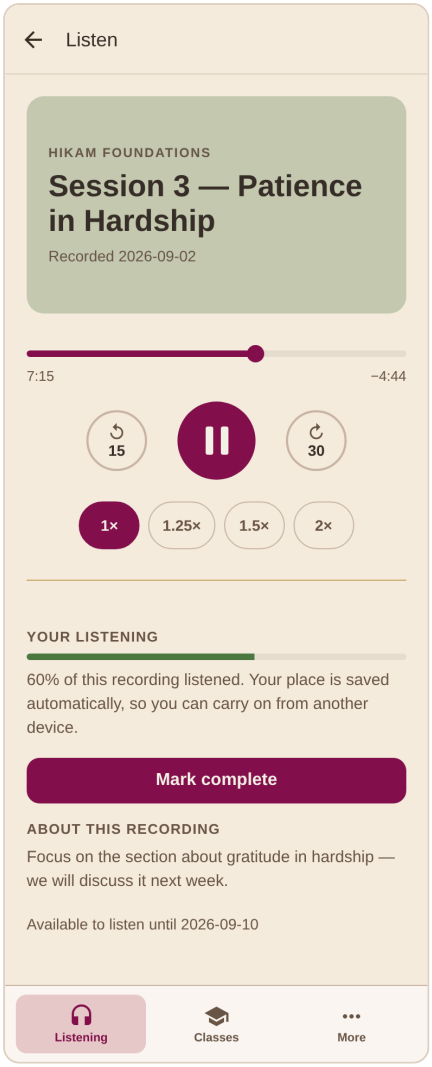
- **Missed** — the date to listen by has passed, with the date it closed. Nothing can be done about these, so they are set quietly rather than as an alarm.
- **Archived** — the class has been archived and listening turned off, so these are no longer required and cannot be played. Quiet, like Missed.
- **Due soon** — the date to listen by is within the next week.
- **Upcoming** — opened to you, with more time.
- **Completed** — recordings you've already marked done.

Each card shows the recording's title, which class it's from, and **Listen by** its date. Tap a card to open it and listen — except a Missed or Archived one, which can no longer be played and so does not open.

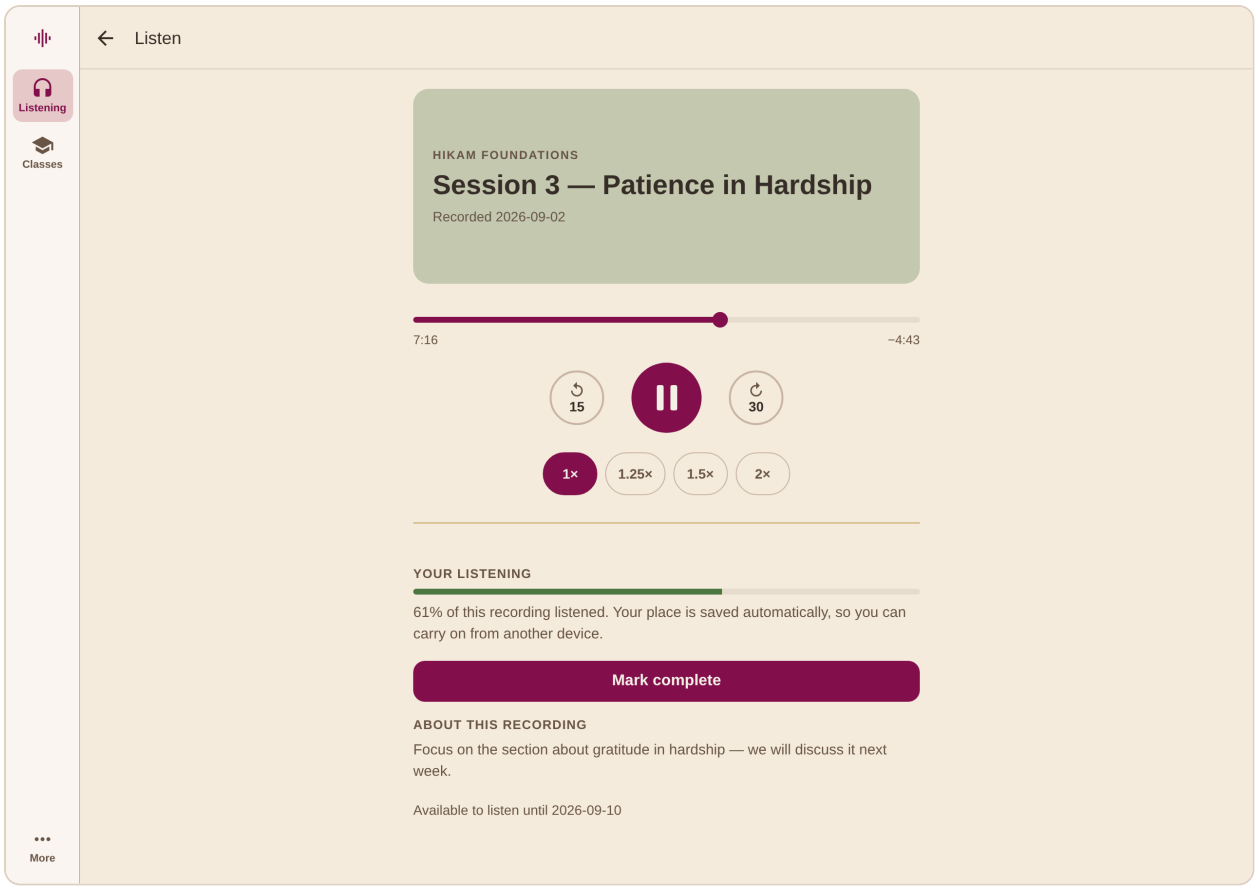
Every recording has a closing date. After it passes you can no longer play that recording — the card stays on your list marked *Missed*, so you can still see what it was, but the audio is closed. Opening it shows **Your record**: how much of it you listened to, and whether it was marked complete. Nothing you did is lost when a recording closes. If you need it reopened, ask your teacher: they can move the date.

One thing worth knowing: if you finish a recording and mark it complete *before* the date, it stays **Completed** forever. It is never turned into a "missed" the next day.

1.3 Listening to a recording



On a phone



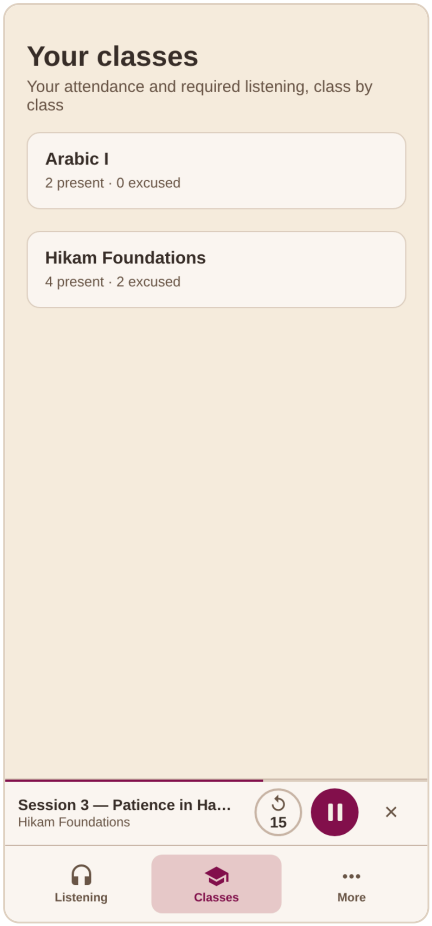
On a computer

The player has everything you'd expect from a podcast app:

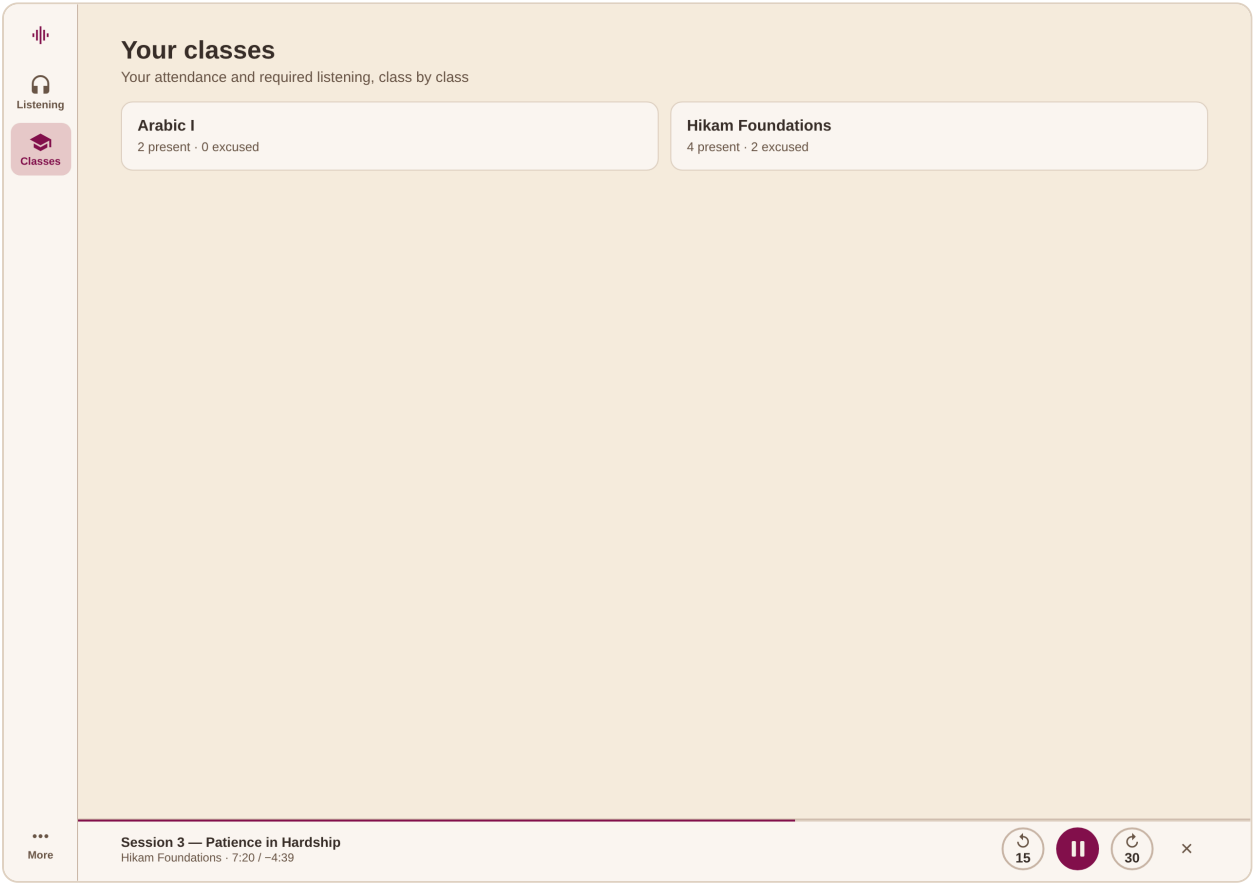
- **The big round button** plays and pauses.
- The two side buttons **skip back 15 seconds** and **skip ahead 30 seconds** — handy for re-hearing a point or moving past a pause.
- **1× / 1.25× / 1.5× / 2×** change the speed without changing the pitch.
- Drag the **progress bar** to jump anywhere. The times below it show how far in you are and how much is left.

A bar shows roughly how much of the recording you've heard. **Your place is saved automatically**, so you can stop on your phone on the bus and pick up on your laptop at home — it remembers where you were.

If the teacher left a note, it appears under **About this recording** — often "focus on this part" or "we'll discuss this next week."



On a phone



On a computer

You can leave this screen without stopping the audio. Go and check your attendance record or open another class — a slim bar keeps showing what's playing, with play/pause and a 15-second skip back, and tapping it brings you back here. On a computer that bar carries the skip forward and the times as well. Closing it with the × is what stops playback.

1.4 Marking a recording complete

The **Mark complete** button is at the bottom of the player. Tap it when you've finished listening, and the recording moves to your **Completed** section.

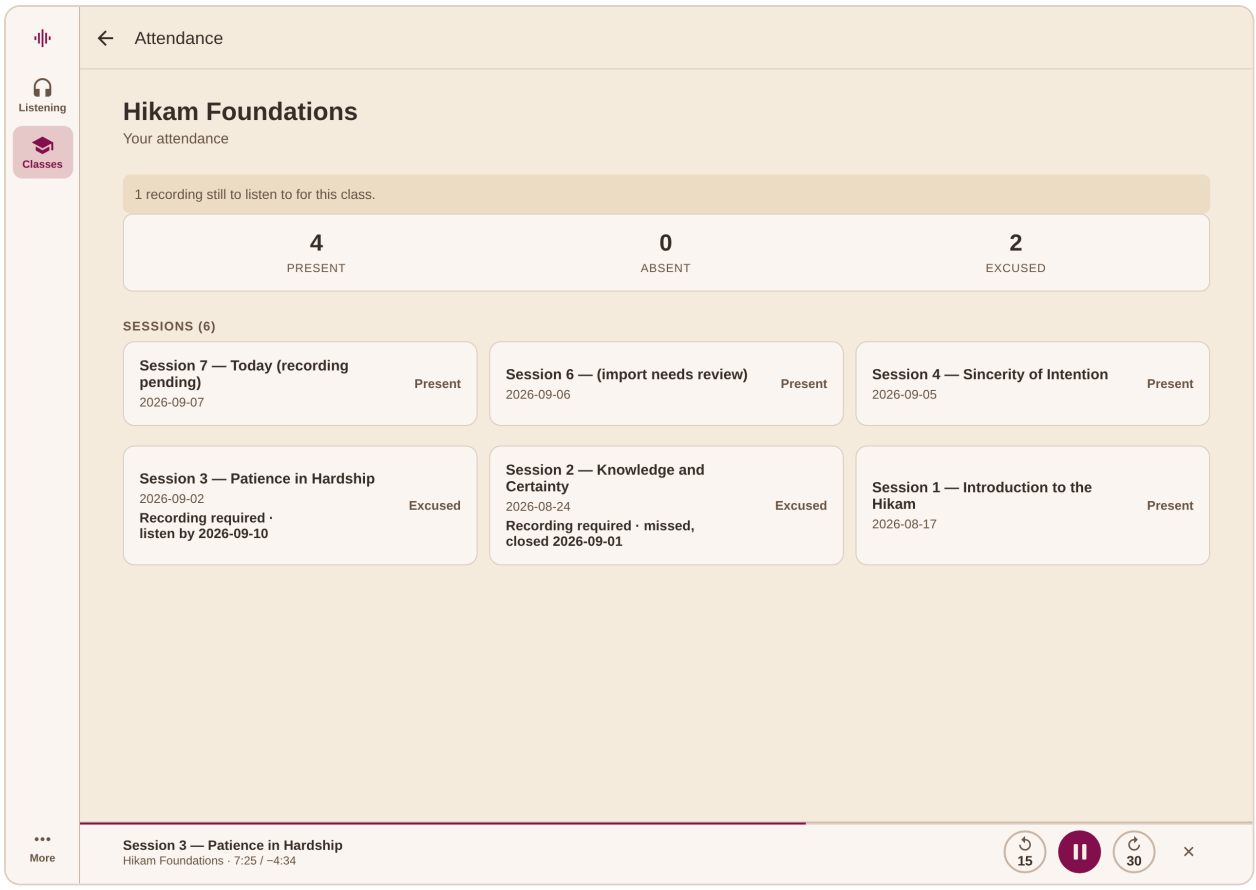
A few things worth knowing:

- **It's on your honor.** The app doesn't force you to listen to every second — it trusts you to mark complete when you're genuinely done. The listening bar is there to help *you* keep your place, not to police you.
- **You do have to press play first.** The button only unlocks once you've started the recording — you can't mark something complete you've never opened.
- **Changed your mind?** You can open a completed recording again and listen more; marking complete isn't a locked door.

1.5 Your attendance record



On a phone



On a computer

Tap **Classes** in the navigation to see the classes you're enrolled in — each one shows your tally at a glance — then tap one to see **your own attendance** for it.

At the top is a tally — how many meetings you were **present** for, **absent** from, and **excused** from. Below it, every meeting your teacher recorded you in, newest first, with the date and your own mark.

Where you were excused, the row also says that a recording was required and whether you've listened to it — so you can check your record without hunting through your listening list.

Two things this page is not: it isn't a way to play anything (that's **Listening**), and it never shows anyone else's attendance. You see your own marks and nobody else's.

1.6 Changing your password

Tap **More**, then **Change password**. The app emails you a link to set a new one — the same kind of link you used when your account was first created. Your account is created for you by the institute; you can't sign yourself up, and there's nothing to create here.

1.7 Listening on a spotty connection

The app is built to survive a bad signal. If you mark a recording complete while you're offline or your connection drops, the app **holds onto that** and syncs it the moment you're back online — even if you close the app in between. You may briefly see a "pending" state; that just means "saved on this device, not yet sent." You don't have to do anything; it sorts itself out.

Streaming the audio itself does need a connection, so for a long class on the go, a stable network (or Wi-Fi before you leave) is your friend.

1.8 Notifications

The app can send you two messages, and only two. Tap **More**, then **Notifications**, to turn either off:

- **A recording is ready for me** — when a class you were excused from has a recording you can listen to. Worth leaving on: it's the only way you'll know one has appeared.
- **Last day to listen** — on the morning of the day a recording closes, if you haven't finished it.

Both start switched on. There's deliberately no message *after* a recording closes: by then there'd be nothing you could do about it.

A message is shown whether the app is open or closed, on the phone and on the website. While you're in the app — listening, say — it appears as a banner, without a sound.

Your choices follow you — they apply on every device you sign in on. Reaching this device needs its permission as well. The app offers to set that up once, on your listening screen after you sign in; you can also tap **Enable notifications** on this screen at any time. If it says they are blocked, use **Open settings** on a phone, or allow them from the site settings behind the icon in your browser's address bar. If it says this device can't show them at all, either the browser doesn't support them or setting them up didn't finish — try again from this screen, and if it keeps saying that, tell Faisal.

Part 2 — For staff

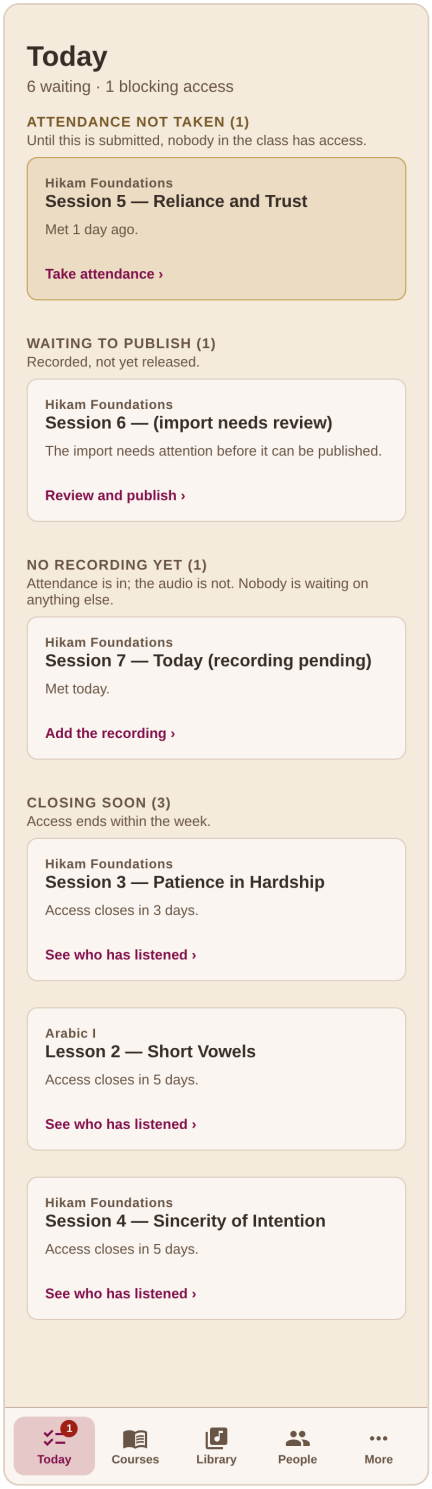
Managers and admins both use this section. A few actions are admin-only and are marked; managers see only the courses they've been assigned to.

2.1 Signing in and getting approved

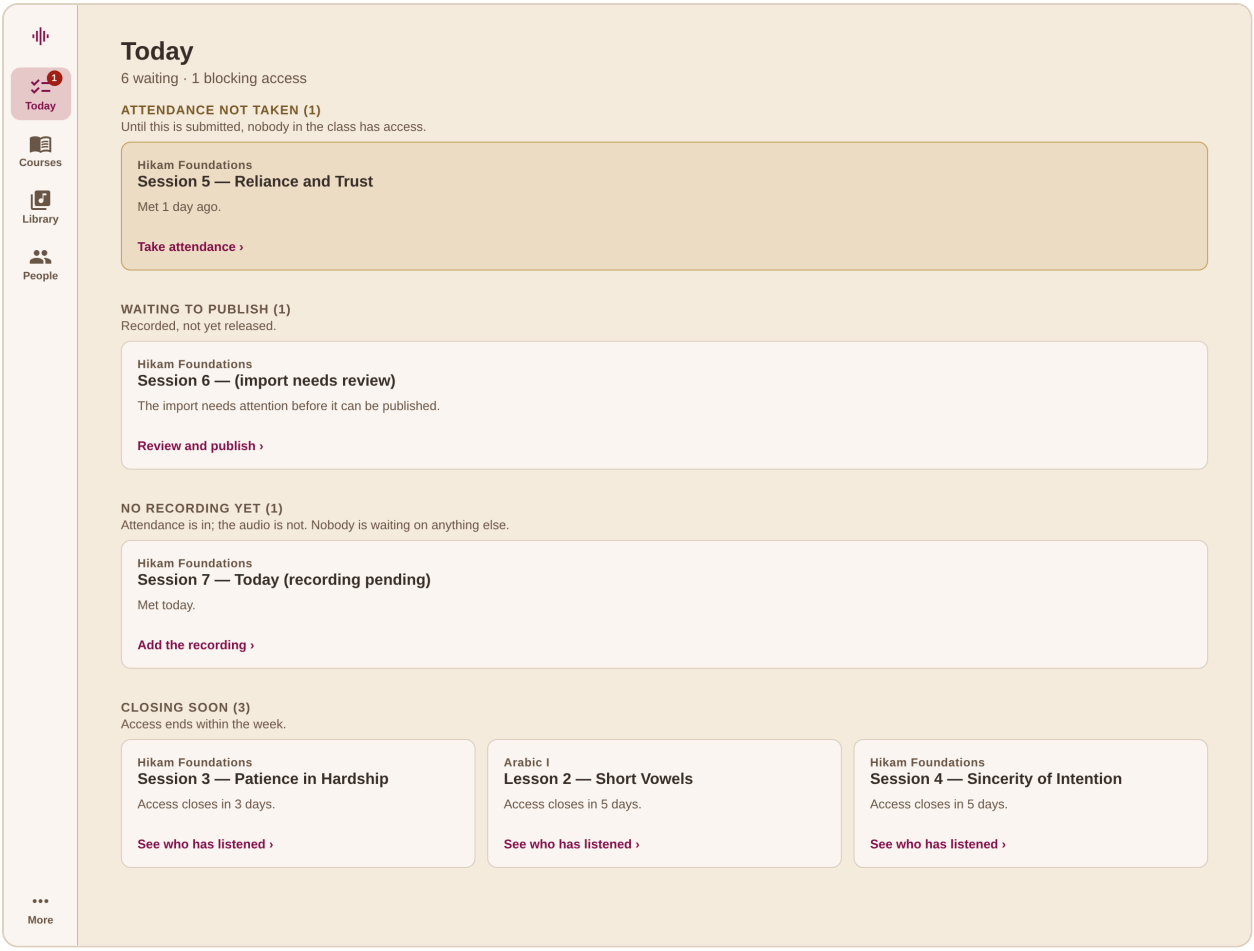
Staff sign in differently from students. On the sign-in screen, use **Sign in with Google** with your Sabeel Google account.

The first time, you'll wait for approval. New staff accounts start as *pending* — an administrator has to approve you and choose your role before you can do anything. The screen updates by itself the moment they do; you do not need to sign in again. (If you're the very first administrator, that step was done for you during setup.)

2.2 Today — what’s waiting



On a phone



On a computer

The app opens on **Today**: everything across your courses that is waiting on you, most urgent first. Every card is a link straight to the screen where you do the thing.

- **Attendance not taken** — a class has met and nobody has submitted the register. This is first and it's the one entry the screen tints, because until it's submitted **nobody in that class has access to the recording** — and nothing else on any screen would tell you.
- **Waiting to publish** — a recording is added but not out: still a draft, an import that needs attention, or one that was published and has since been unpublished or archived.
- **No recording yet** — attendance is in, the audio isn't.
- **Closing soon** — access to a recording ends within the week; a good moment to see who still hasn't listened.

The number on the **Today** tab counts what is blocking access right now: a register not yet submitted, and a recording that was published and has since been taken back — unpublished, or archived before its Listen by date. A draft that has never been published is waiting on you but is blocking nobody, so it is in the list without being in the count. Archiving *after* the Listen by date took nothing away from anyone, so it is simply filing and says nothing here.

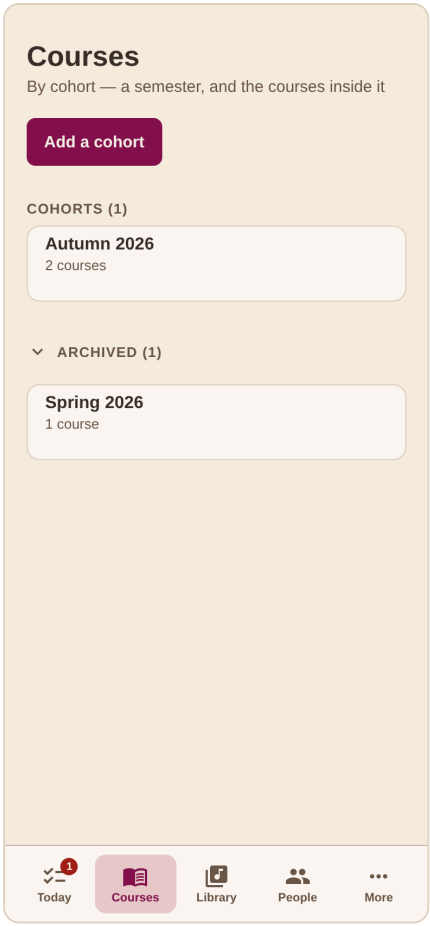
If you run more courses than one screen can watch at once, Today says so above the list — the rest are still there under **Courses**, they are just not in this count.

A card disappears the moment you close the gap, and the count goes with it. An empty Today is the answer, not a blank screen: it means attendance is in, every recording is published, and nothing closes this week.

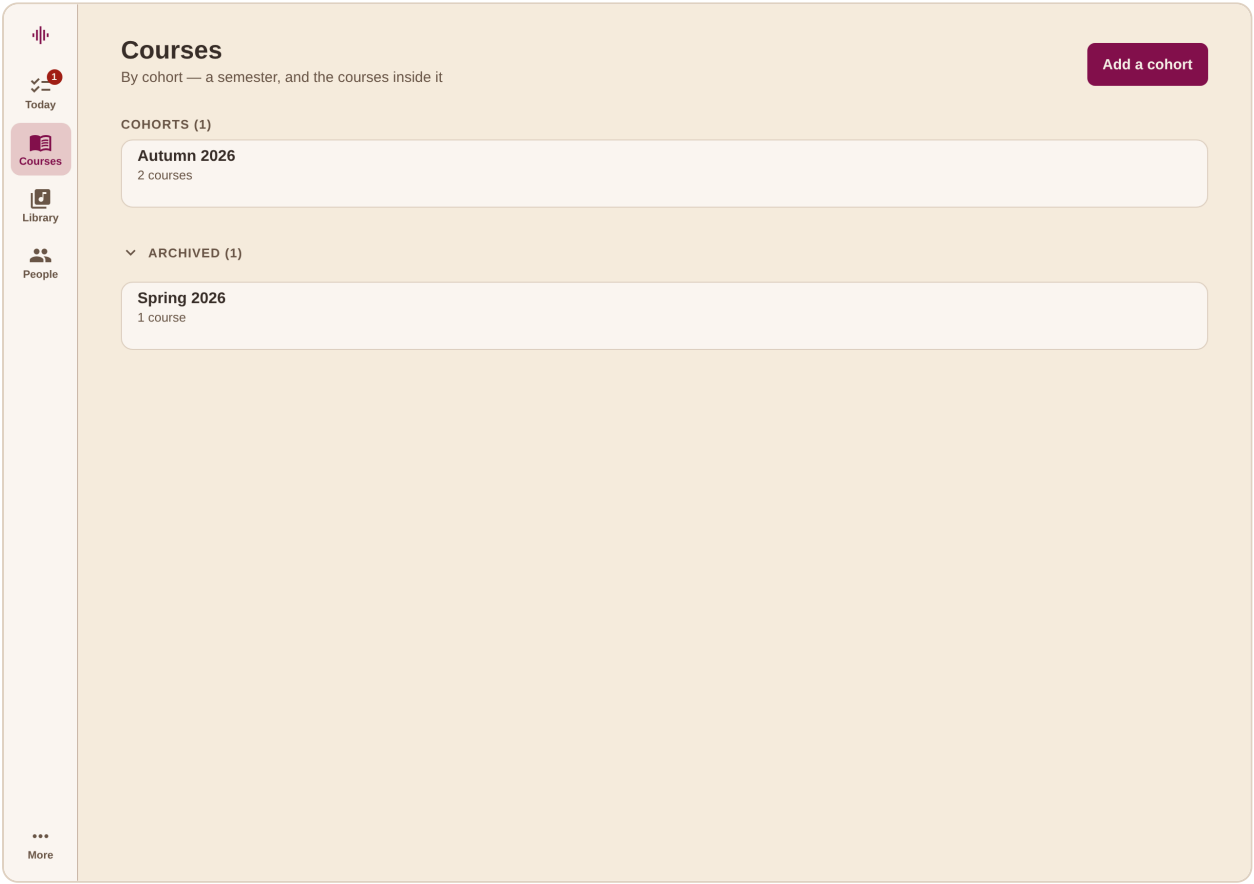
The rest of the navigation is the structure: **Courses** (cohorts and their courses for an admin, your own courses for a manager), **Library**, **People**, and **More**.

2.3 Cohorts, courses, and a course at a glance

The structure is **Cohort → Course → Session → Recording**. A **cohort** is a term or intake (like “Autumn 2026”). A **course** is a subject taught over that term. A **session** is one dated meeting of the course, and a **recording** is the audio of that meeting.



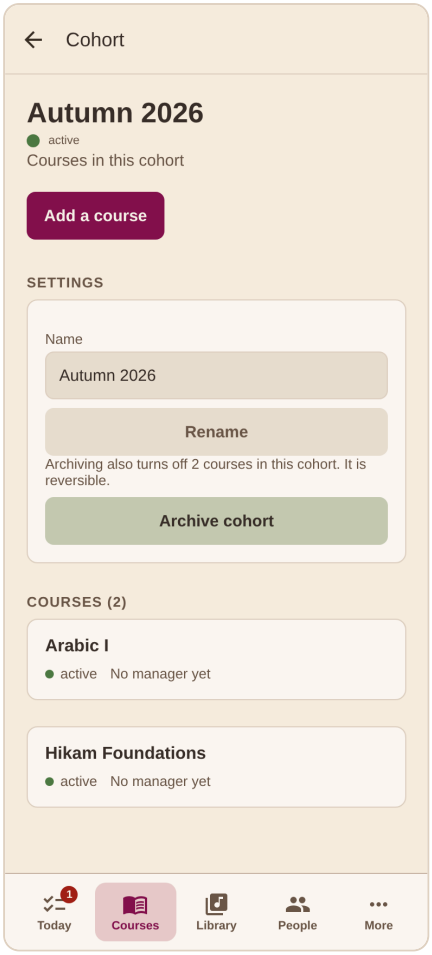
On a phone



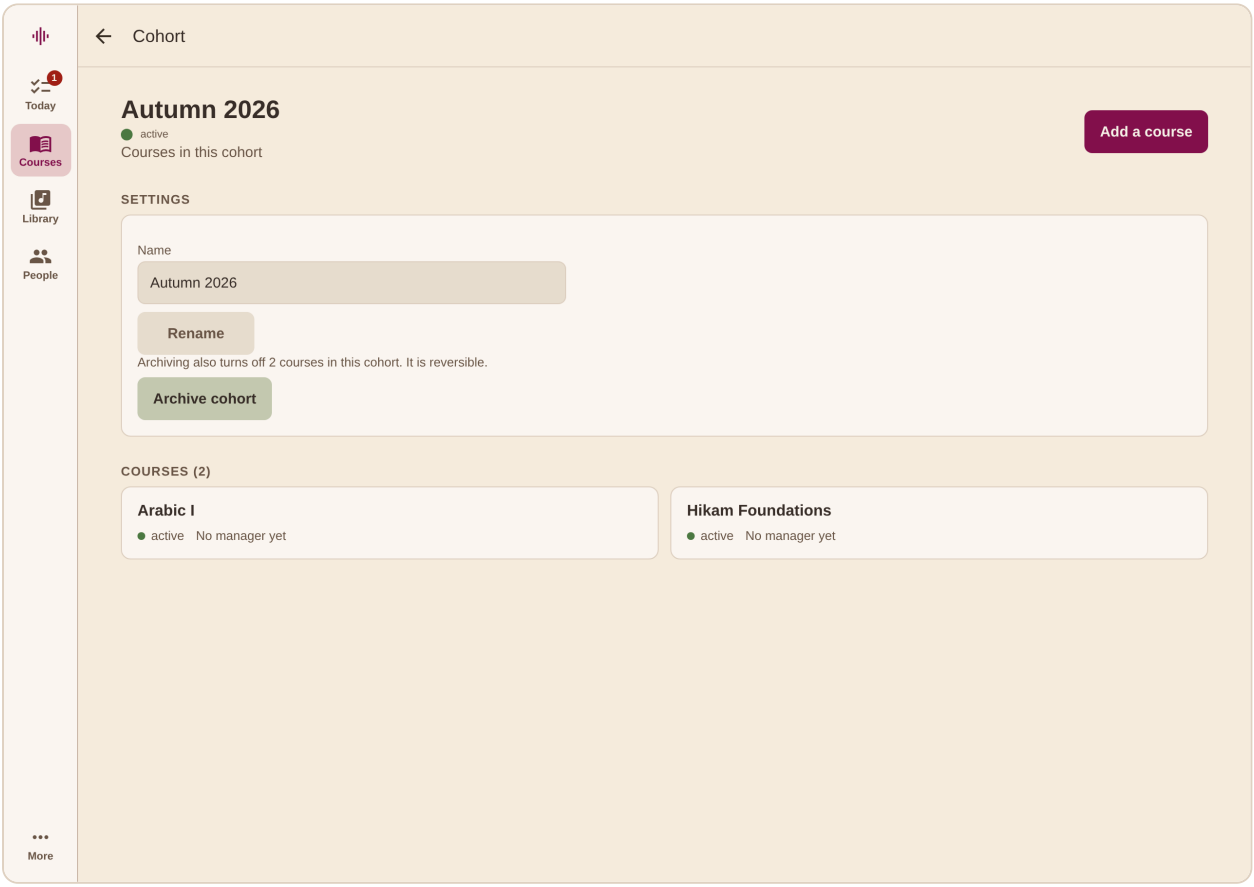
On a computer

Finished terms move into an **Archived** section at the bottom of the cohort list — tap the heading to open it.

Open a cohort to see **its settings and its courses**, and open a course to work with it. The cohort's settings — **admins only**, like everything that shapes the structure — are where you **rename** it (change the name and tap **Rename**) and where you **archive** it, in the same way a course is renamed and archived from the course page. Archiving a cohort turns off every course in it; reactivating puts each course back to the setting it had.

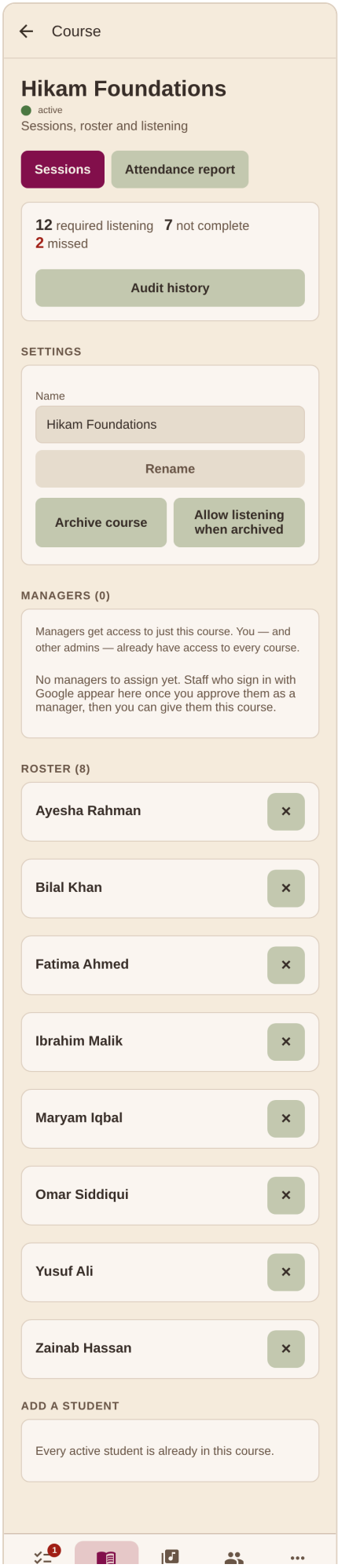


On a phone



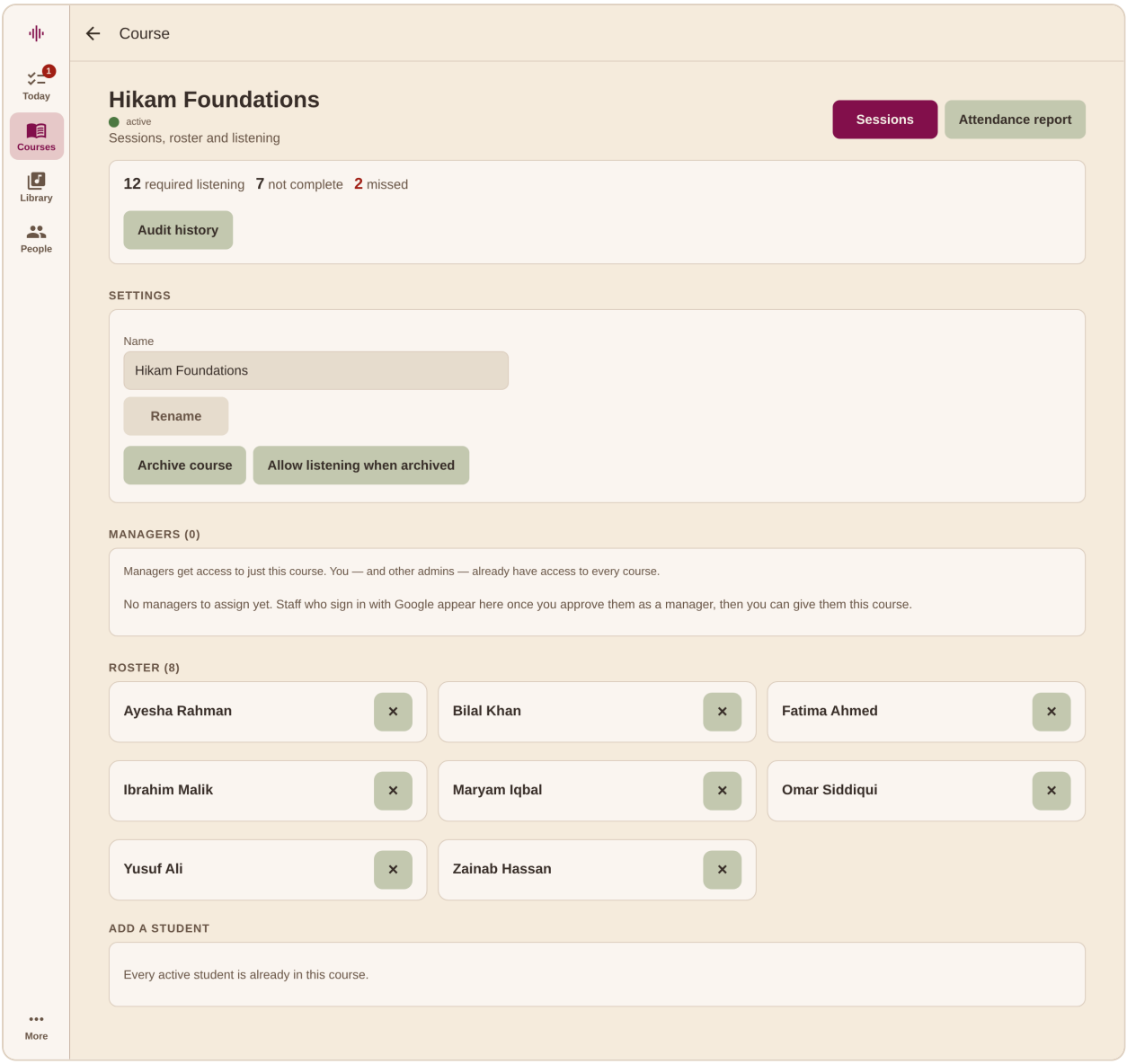
On a computer

The **course page** is your dashboard for that course:


Course
Hikam Foundations
active
Sessions, roster and listening
Sessions
Attendance report
12 required listening 7 not complete
2 missed
Audit history
SETTINGS
Name
Hikam Foundations
Rename
Archive course
Allow listening when archived
MANAGERS (0)
Managers get access to just this course. You — and other admins — already have access to every course.
No managers to assign yet. Staff who sign in with Google appear here once you approve them as a manager, then you can give them this course.
ROSTER (8)
Ayesha Rahman
Bilal Khan
Fatima Ahmed
Ibrahim Malik
Maryam Iqbal
Omar Siddiqui
Yusuf Ali
Zainab Hassan
ADD A STUDENT
Every active student is already in this course.



On a phone

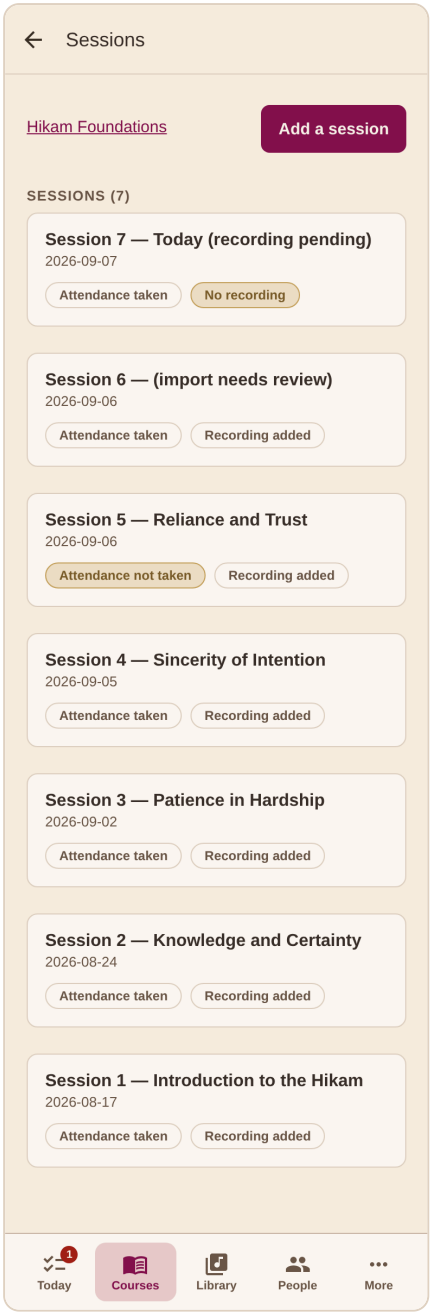


On a computer

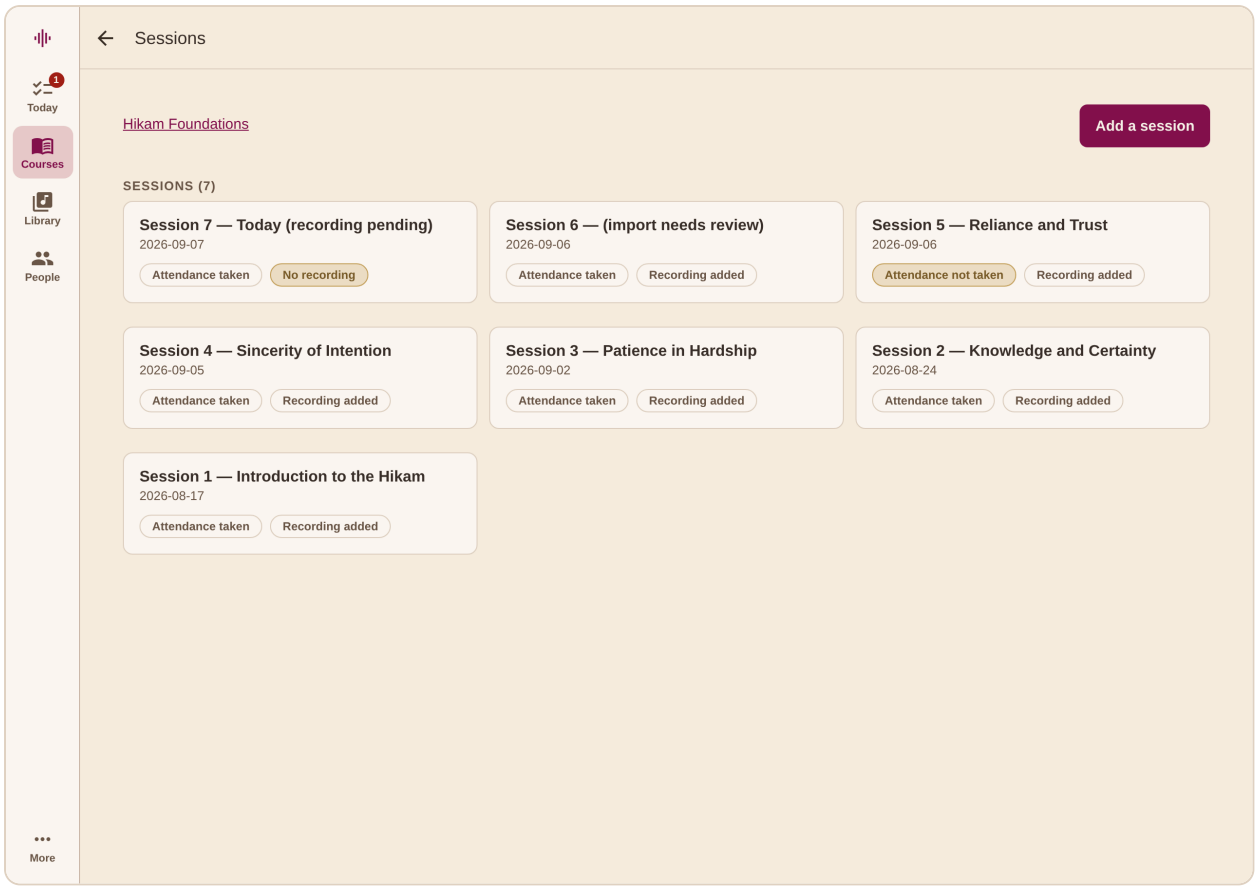
- **Sessions** takes you to the course's meetings, where attendance and recordings live (Section 2.4).
- **Attendance report** summarizes attendance and catch-up across the whole course (Section 2.9).
- The counts card — *N required listening / not complete / missed* — is the whole course's required listening at a glance, and links straight to the course **Audit history**.
- **Settings** (admins) lets you rename the course, **archive** it when the term ends, and choose whether students may still listen to an archived course's recordings.

- **Managers** (admins) lists the staff assigned to *this* course. Managers only ever see and act on the courses they're assigned to here — being in a cohort grants nothing by itself. A manager's own course page has neither section.
- **Roster** lists the enrolled students. Tap a student to see their personal ledger for the course (Section 2.8).
- **Export workbook** downloads the whole course — every student, session, register and required listening — as one Excel file (Section 2.13).

2.4 Sessions, attendance, and adding a recording



On a phone



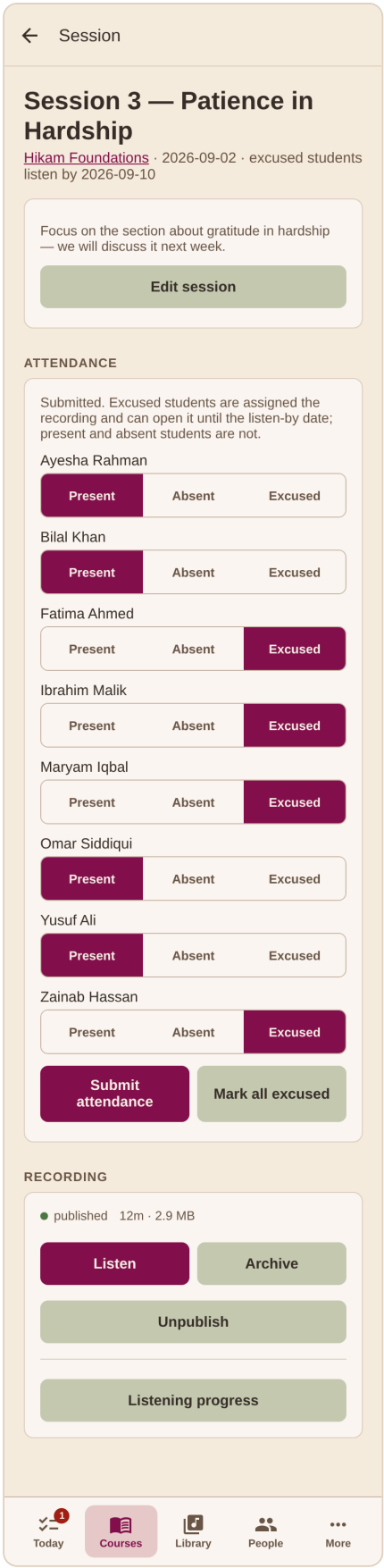
On a computer

A **session** is one class meeting. Create one for each meeting — give it a title, its date, and a **Listen by** date. Each session card shows at a glance whether **attendance** has been taken and whether a **recording** has been added, so you can see what's still outstanding.

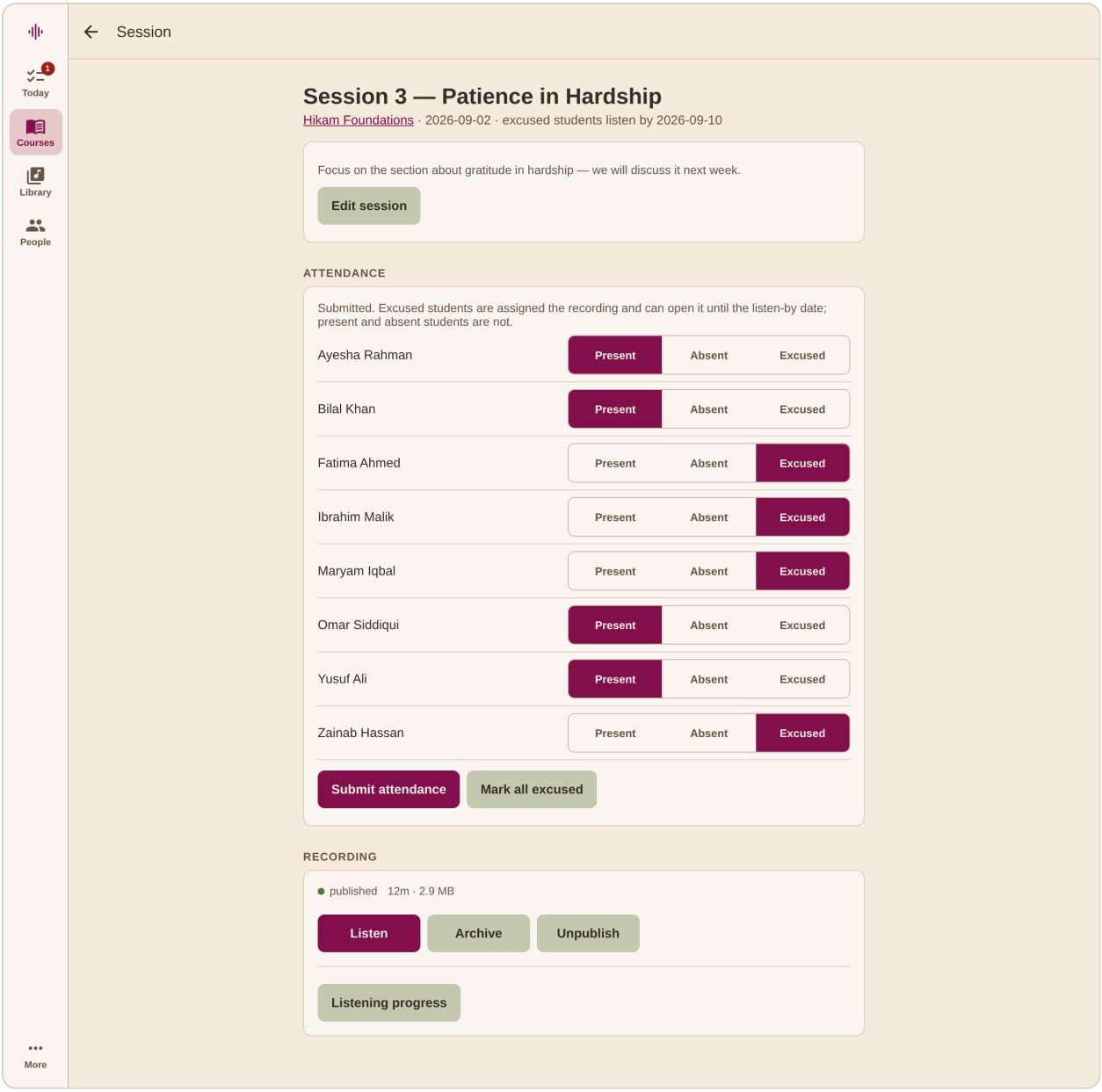
The "Listen by" date is required, and it matters more than it looks. It is the day the recording *closes* to the students you excused — after it, they can no longer play it. It fills in automatically as a week after the meeting (or today, if the meeting was long enough ago that a week later has already been and gone); change it to whatever suits. You can't *move* it into the past, and you can move it forward later to reopen a session for someone who needs longer. Everything else about a closed session stays editable — fix a title or a date on a session whose Listen by date has passed and the date simply stays as it is.

The **course name under the heading is a link** — on the sessions list, on a session, and on the attendance report. Tap it to go straight back to the course. The back arrow takes you one step back the way you came; this takes you to the course itself, however many steps in you are, and it works even when you have opened a session from a link somebody sent you.

Open a session to work with it:


Session
Session 3 — Patience in Hardship
Hikam Foundations · 2026-09-02 · excused students listen by 2026-09-10
Focus on the section about gratitude in hardship — we will discuss it next week.
Edit session
ATTENDANCE
Submitted. Excused students are assigned the recording and can open it until the listen-by date; present and absent students are not.
Ayesha Rahman
Present
Absent
Excused
Bilal Khan
Present
Absent
Excused
Fatima Ahmed
Present
Absent
Excused
Ibrahim Malik
Present
Absent
Excused
Maryam Iqbal
Present
Absent
Excused
Omar Siddiqui
Present
Absent
Excused
Yusuf Ali
Present
Absent
Excused
Zainab Hassan
Present
Absent
Excused
Submit attendance
Mark all excused
RECORDING
published 12m · 2.9 MB
Listen
Archive
Unpublish
Listening progress
Today
1
Courses
Library
People
More

On a phone



On a computer

Take attendance. For each enrolled student, choose **Present**, **Absent**, or **Excused**, then tap **Submit attendance**. Everyone starts as *Present*, so often you only flip the few who missed. You can re-submit a corrected attendance later and everything updates automatically.

Excusing a student is what gives them the recording. It is the only mark that does:

- **Present** — they were there. Nothing is required of them, and the recording is not opened to them.
- **Excused** — they missed it with your permission. The recording opens to them and listening to it is required, until the Listen by date.
- **Absent** — they missed it without being excused. Nothing is opened to them.

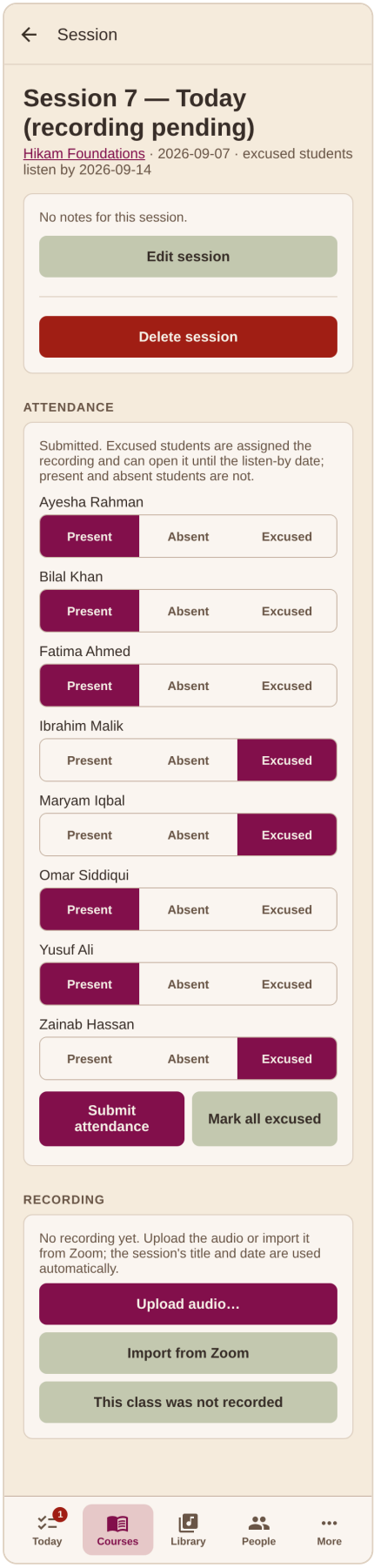
So **Mark all excused** is the one-tap shortcut for “everyone must listen to this one.” And if someone genuinely needs to catch up on a class you marked them absent for, just change their mark to Excused and submit again.

One limit worth knowing: you can’t excuse anyone *new* for a session whose Listen by date has already passed — it would hand them something they could never open. Move the date forward first, then excuse them. Correcting a closed session in every other way still works, including changing someone from excused to present or absent, so the attendance record never becomes uncorrectable.

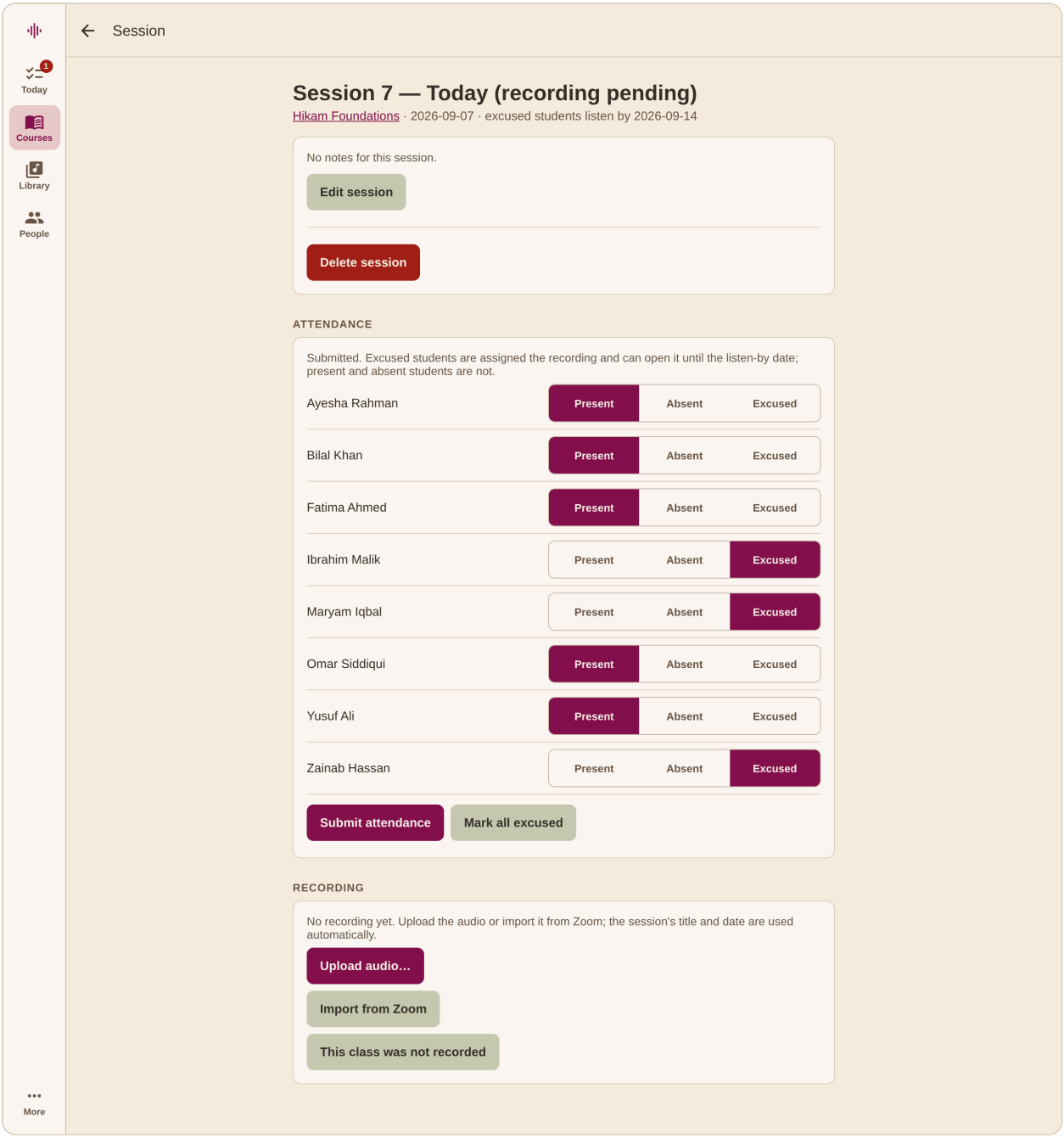
Add the recording. In the same screen, **Upload audio…** or import it from Zoom. It’s **audio only** — up to 300 MB, though a two-hour class is normally well under 30 MB. (Uploading audio rather than a video file is the single biggest thing that keeps this app free to run.) The recording takes its title, date, and notes from the session, so you don’t retype them.

Importing from Zoom. Every class in a cohort is held in the same recurring Zoom meeting, so every recording in the list has the same title. What tells them apart is when the audio ran: each card shows the date and the hours, for example *2026-10-08 · 6:02–8:18 PM*, so the 6 pm and 7 pm classes of one evening are two different cards. The list opens showing only recordings from the session’s own date. Untick **Only recordings from this session’s date** to see everything in the date range. Dates and hours are institute time (America/Chicago), so an evening class is listed under the day it was held.

Or say it wasn’t recorded. Some classes aren’t, and until you say so the app keeps asking: **Today** shows the session as waiting for its recording, and you get the “attendance still not taken” reminder every morning. **This class was not recorded** stops both. It changes nothing else — the register stays exactly as it is, and the marks in it still count — and **It was recorded after all** puts the session back if you change your mind.


Session
Session 7 — Today (recording pending)
Hikam Foundations · 2026-09-07 · excused students listen by 2026-09-14
No notes for this session.
Edit session
Delete session
ATTENDANCE
Submitted. Excused students are assigned the recording and can open it until the listen-by date; present and absent students are not.
Ayesha Rahman
Present
Absent
Excused
Bilal Khan
Present
Absent
Excused
Fatima Ahmed
Present
Absent
Excused
Ibrahim Malik
Present
Absent
Excused
Maryam Iqbal
Present
Absent
Excused
Omar Siddiqui
Present
Absent
Excused
Yusuf Ali
Present
Absent
Excused
Zainab Hassan
Present
Absent
Excused
Submit attendance
Mark all excused
RECORDING
No recording yet. Upload the audio or import it from Zoom; the session's title and date are used automatically.
Upload audio…
Import from Zoom
This class was not recorded
Today
1
Courses
Library
People
More

On a phone



On a computer

Each recording moves through a few states:

- **Draft** — added, not yet visible to students. You can replace its audio freely.
- **Published** — live. The students you excused can now listen, and are on the hook for it. Publishing is blocked if the session's Listen by date has already passed, because nobody would be able to open it.
- **Needs attention** — flagged for a problem (for example, a Zoom import that needs review). Publish is blocked until it has audio.

- **Unpublished** — pulled back from students after being live. It goes back to Draft to be fixed, then out again.
- **Archived** — closed for good, one recording at a time. Like unpublishing, it closes the recording to everyone who was excused, so **Today** raises it if you archive one whose Listen by date has not passed yet. One tap puts it back — while that date is still ahead. Once it has passed, Publish is greyed out and the card says why: publishing then would give nobody access, so move the session's **Listen by** date forward first, which reopens it for everyone excused.

Archiving or unpublishing a recording takes it out of the course totals. Everything that happened on it — who completed it, who missed it — leaves the course page's counts, the attendance report's catch-up columns and each student's per-course counts, as if it had never been required. The recording's own **Listening progress** page still keeps its rows (Section 2.8), but nothing sums it into the term. So this is not how a term ends: **to close a term, archive the course** (Section 2.3), which keeps every count and only decides whether students may still listen. Reach for archiving a recording only when that recording itself should be withdrawn.

2.5 How a recording becomes required listening

Here's the rule that runs the whole ledger:

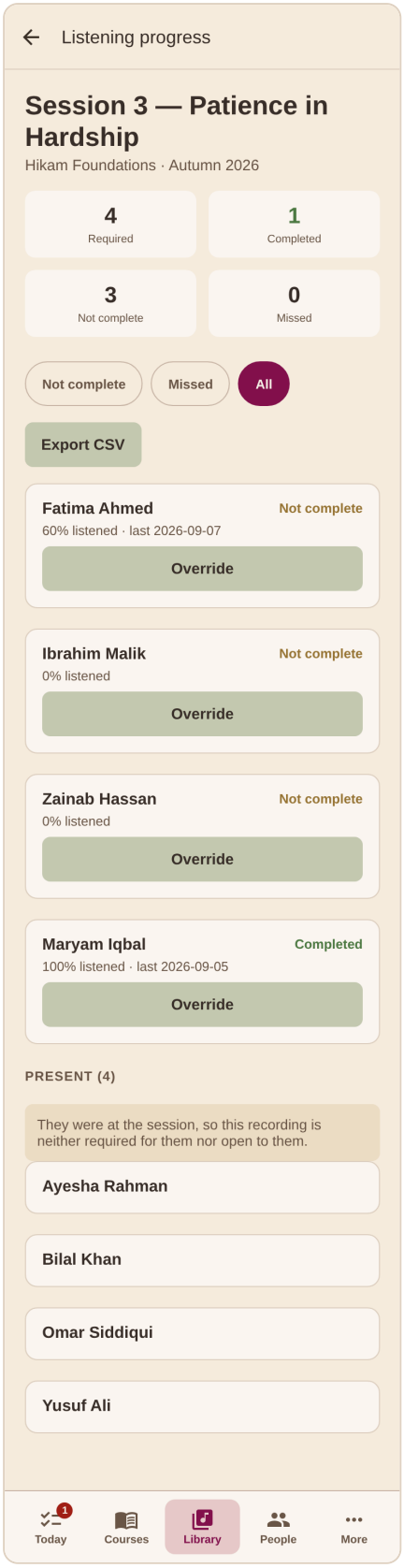
> **A recording opens to the students marked EXCUSED for its session, and to nobody else** — automatically, once the recording is **published** and its attendance has been **submitted**. The same fact makes listening required. It closes again when the session's **Listen by** date passes.

You never assign students one by one; the attendance sheet is the assignment. If you correct attendance — flip someone from excused to present, or the reverse — access and obligations update to match, and any listening or completion already recorded is kept.

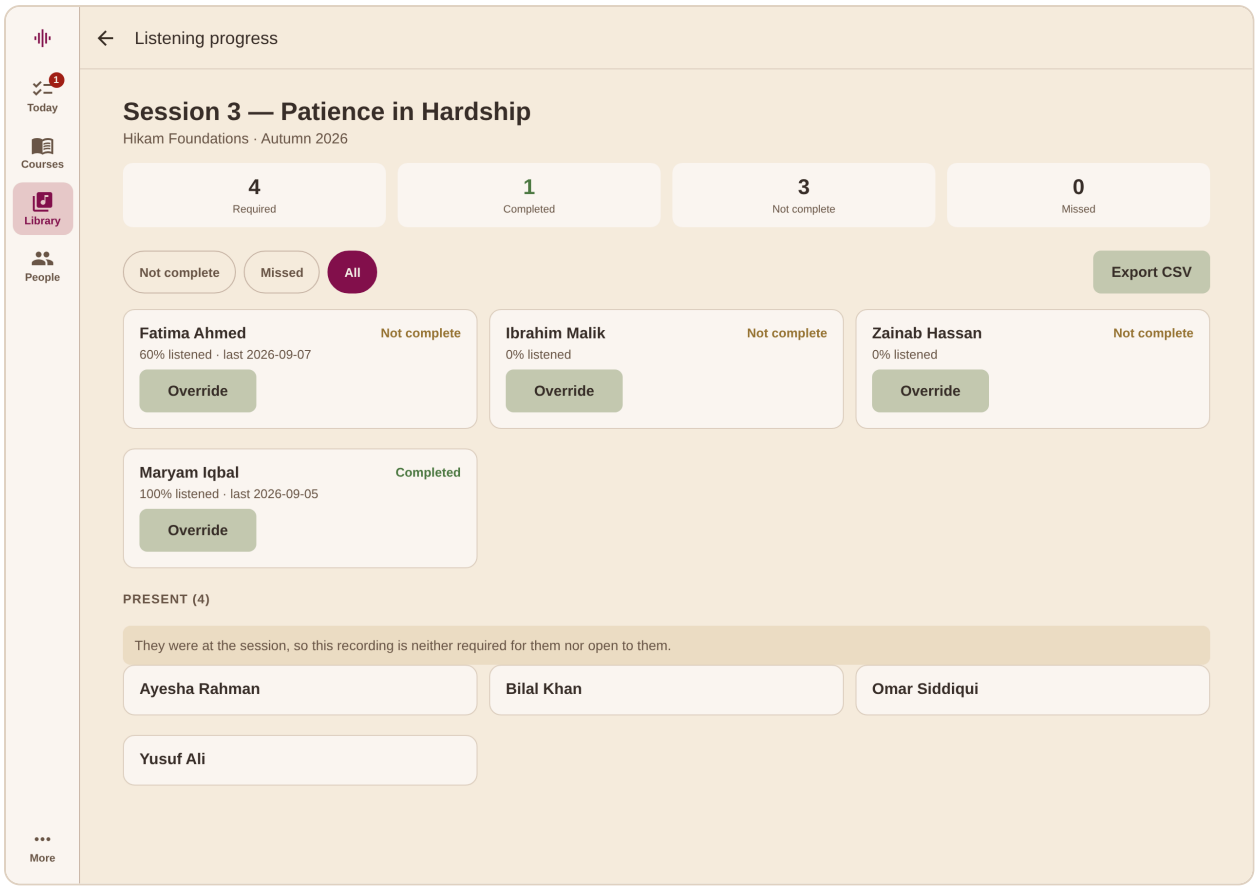
- **Being enrolled opens nothing.** A student in the class who was present, or absent without being excused, cannot play the recording at all.
- **The Listen by date closes it.** After that day the student sees the recording on their list marked *Missed*, with the date it closed, and can no longer play it. Move the session's Listen by date forward to reopen it.

- **A student who joins late** wasn't on the roster when earlier attendance was taken, so they are **not** retroactively given those older sessions. On an earlier session's register they appear as *not marked* — correcting somebody else's mark there leaves them that way. If you *do* want a latecomer to catch up on an earlier one, open that session, mark them **Excused**, and re-submit attendance.
- **Unpublishing** a recording closes it to everyone again.

2.6 The recording ledger — who has caught up



On a phone



On a computer

Open a recording's **Listening progress** (from its session, or from the library) to see exactly where things stand. Up top, four counts: **required** (the students you excused, the only ones who can open it), **completed**, **not complete**, and **missed**. An archived or unpublished recording keeps this page: the counts and rows are the record as it stood when it closed, and a grant that was still open then reads *Closed (recording archived)*. It is the only place that record survives — the course totals no longer include it (Section 2.6).

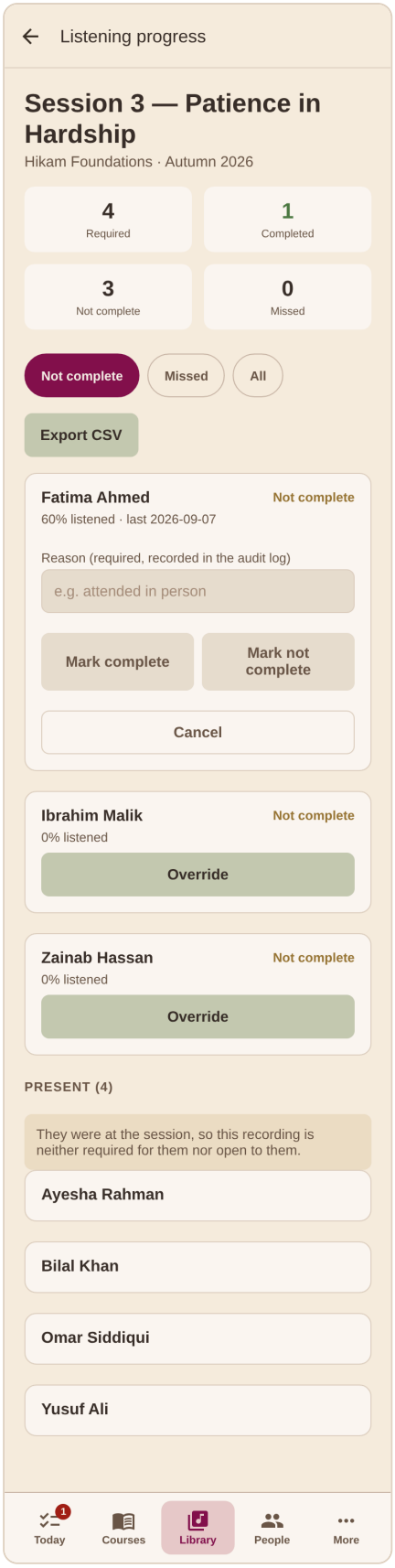
The screen has five parts:

- **The required list** — the students you excused, each with how much they've listened, when they last listened, and their status: **Completed**, **Not complete**, or **Missed**. The **filter chips** — *Not complete / Missed / All* — open on **Not complete**, so you land on exactly the people who still need a nudge.
- **Present** — the students who were there. The recording is neither required for them nor open to them.
- **Absent** — marked absent rather than excused, so it was never opened to them. To let one of them catch up, mark them **Excused** on the session and submit again.

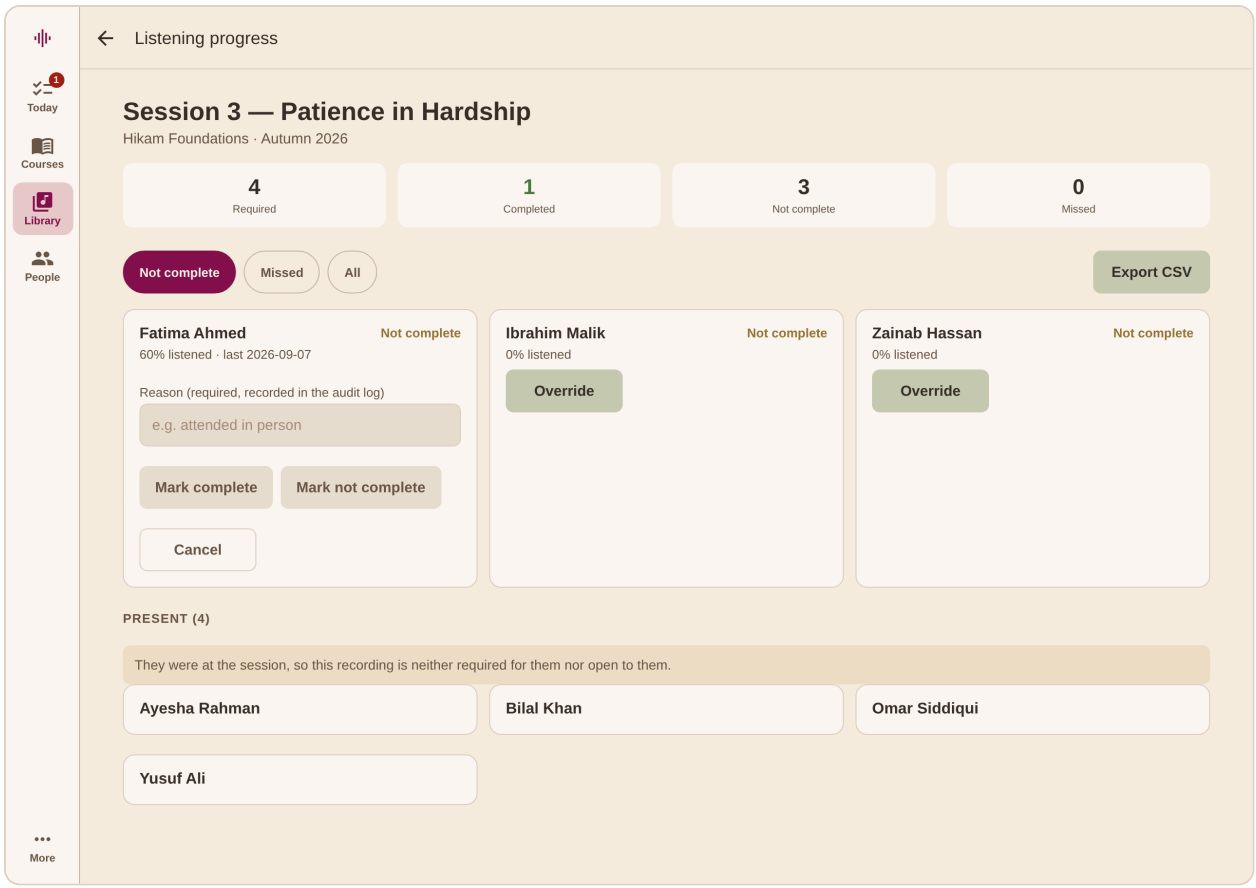
- **Excused, access closed** — students you excused whose access has since been withdrawn: they were unenrolled from the class, or the recording was unpublished or archived. Nothing is required of them and they can't open it. Re-enrolling them, or publishing the recording again, restores it — for anything still inside its **Listen by** date. A session whose date has already passed stays closed, so nobody comes back to an obligation they had no chance to meet.
- **Also listened** — listening from someone who no longer holds the recording, for example a student you excused, who listened, and whom you then corrected to present. Kept as history.

For a copy you can keep or hand on, export the course's **workbook** from the course page (Section 2.13); its **Detail** tab is this ledger for every recording in the course.

2.7 Overriding a completion



On a phone



On a computer

Sometimes the ledger and reality differ — a student caught up in person, or listened on someone else's device. Tap **Override** on their row to set the status yourself:

- Enter a **reason** — it's **required**, and it's written into the audit history so there's always a record of why. "Caught up with the teacher one-on-one" is a good example.
- Choose **Mark complete** or **Mark not complete**.

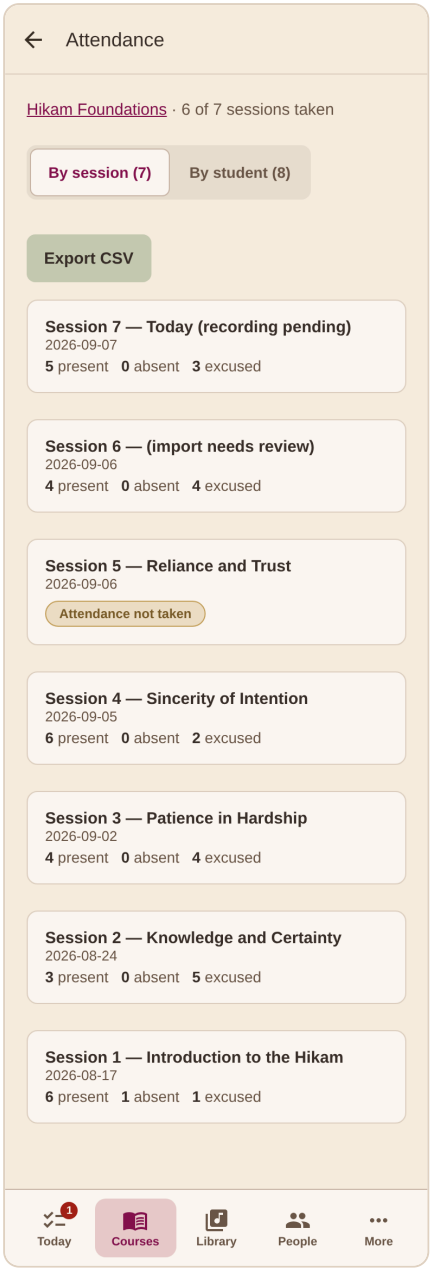
An override **wins over the student's own mark**. If you mark someone complete and they later fiddle with their own status, your override stands. To undo it, open the row again and **Remove override** — the status falls back to whatever the student's own listening says. Every override, and every removal, is audited.

The student sees it too, with the reason you typed — on their player, in their list, and in what the app counts as outstanding. Somebody you have marked complete stops being asked to listen and stops getting the last-day reminder, and they cannot unmark what you set. Write the reason for them as much as for the record: "Caught up with the teacher one-on-one" is read by the person it is about.

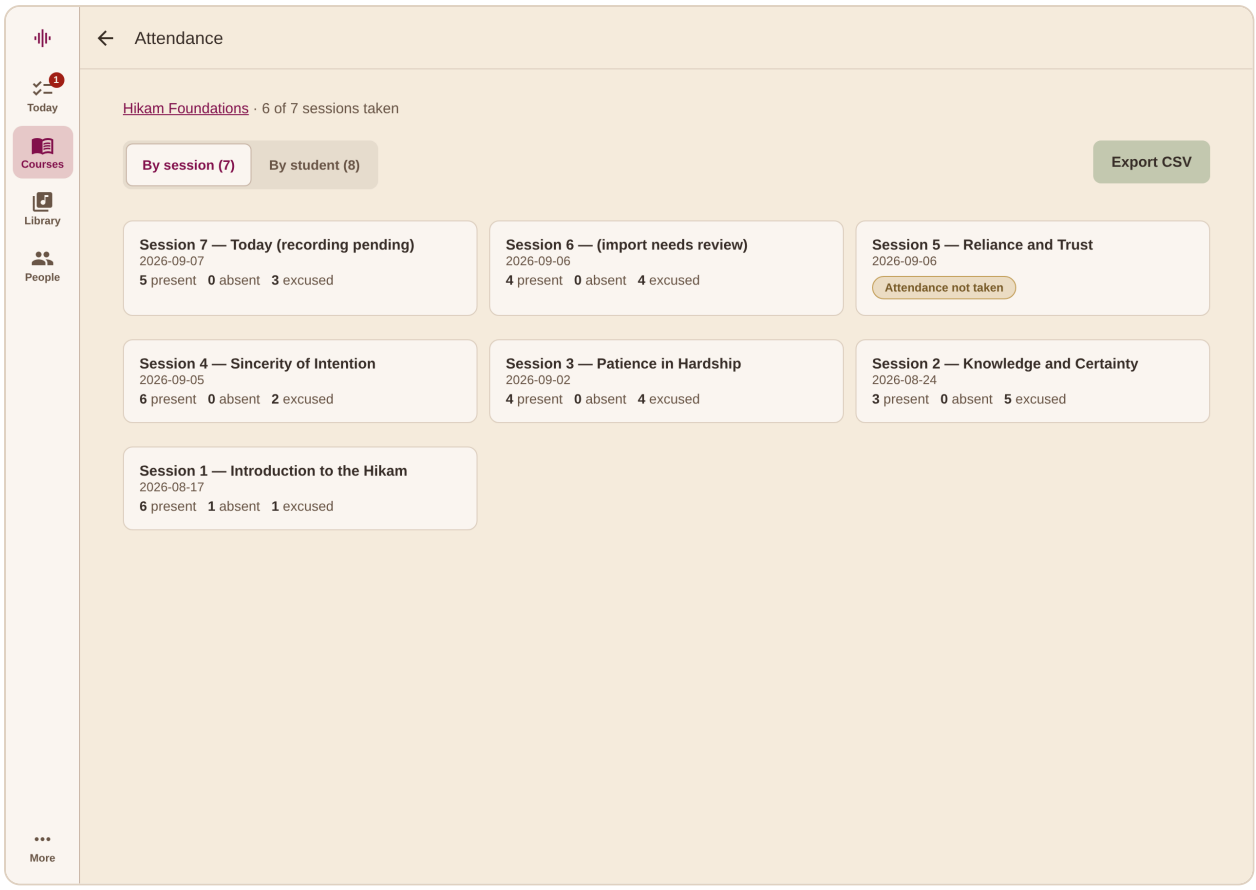
2.8 One student’s ledger

From a course’s **Roster**, tap a student to see *their* view: the recordings they’re required to listen to in that course, each with its status, and the same action-first filters. It’s the per-person counterpart to the per-recording ledger in 2.6 — the right screen when a parent or student asks “where do I stand?” Tap the student’s **name** at the top to open their profile — the same page People opens — for their access, every course they are in, and their history.

2.9 The attendance report



On a phone



On a computer

Reached from the course page, the **attendance report** rolls the whole course up two ways — a toggle switches between them:

- **By session** — every session with its present / absent / excused counts, and a clear flag on any meeting where attendance was never taken.
- **By student** — each student's attendance across the course (chronic absentees first), plus their **catch-up** status: of the recordings they were excused from, how many are complete and how many they missed.

The course **workbook** (Section 2.13) carries the same numbers in a form you can keep: the **Students** and **Sessions** tabs are these two views, and the **Register** tab is the roster with every mark.

Tap any card to go straight to the detail. A session opens that session — its attendance roster and its recording; a student opens that student's listening progress for the course. So the report is where you spot the problem, and one tap is where you deal with it.

2.10 The recording library

Recording library

Every recording, across every cohort

all | published | draft | archived | unpublished | needs attention

All cohorts | All courses

8 total · 7 published · 1 needs attention

Session 6 — (import needs review)
Hikam Foundations · Autumn 2026
needs attention 12 min · 2026-09-10
Listen

Session 5 — Reliance and Trust
Hikam Foundations · Autumn 2026
published 12 min · 2026-09-10
Listen | Listening progress

Session 4 — Sincerity of Intention
Hikam Foundations · Autumn 2026
published 12 min · 2026-09-09
Listen | Listening progress

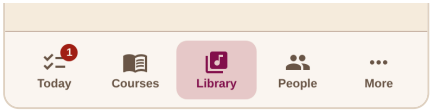
Lesson 2 — Short Vowels
Arabic I · Autumn 2026
published 12 min · 2026-09-07
Listen | Listening progress

Session 3 — Patience in Hardship
Hikam Foundations · Autumn 2026
published 12 min · 2026-09-06
Listen | Listening progress

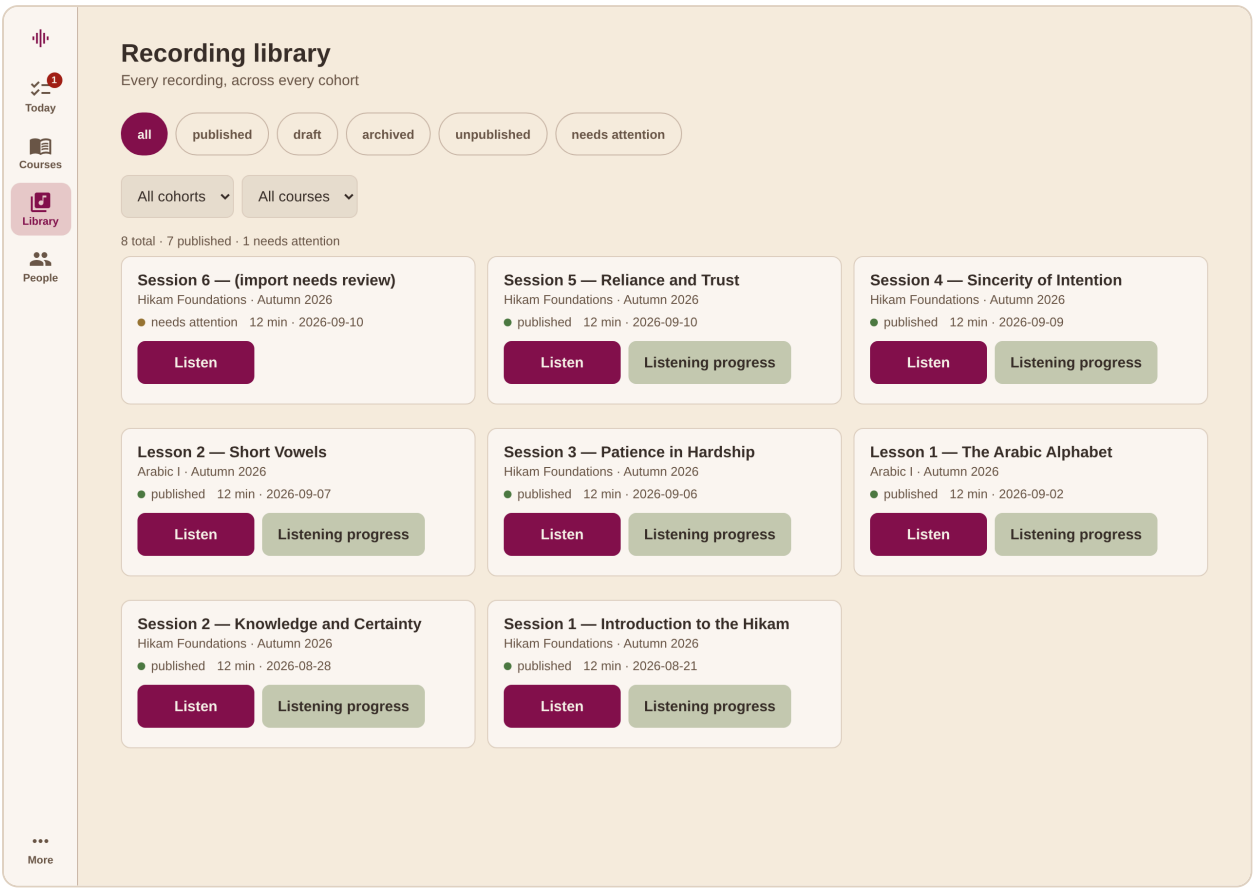
Lesson 1 — The Arabic Alphabet
Arabic I · Autumn 2026
published 12 min · 2026-09-02
Listen | Listening progress

Session 2 — Knowledge and Certainty
Hikam Foundations · Autumn 2026
published 12 min · 2026-08-28
Listen | Listening progress

Session 1 — Introduction to the Hikam
Hikam Foundations · Autumn 2026
published 12 min · 2026-08-21
Listen | Listening progress



On a phone

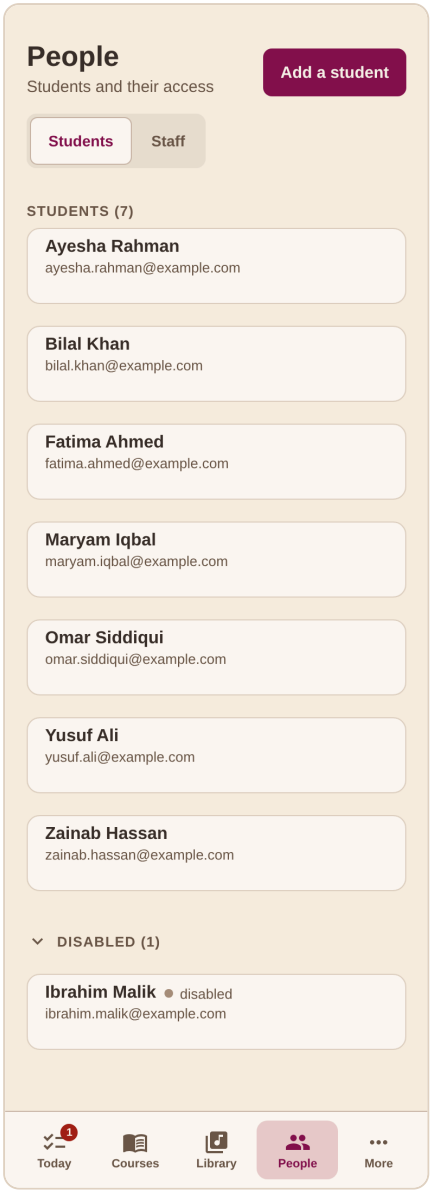


On a computer

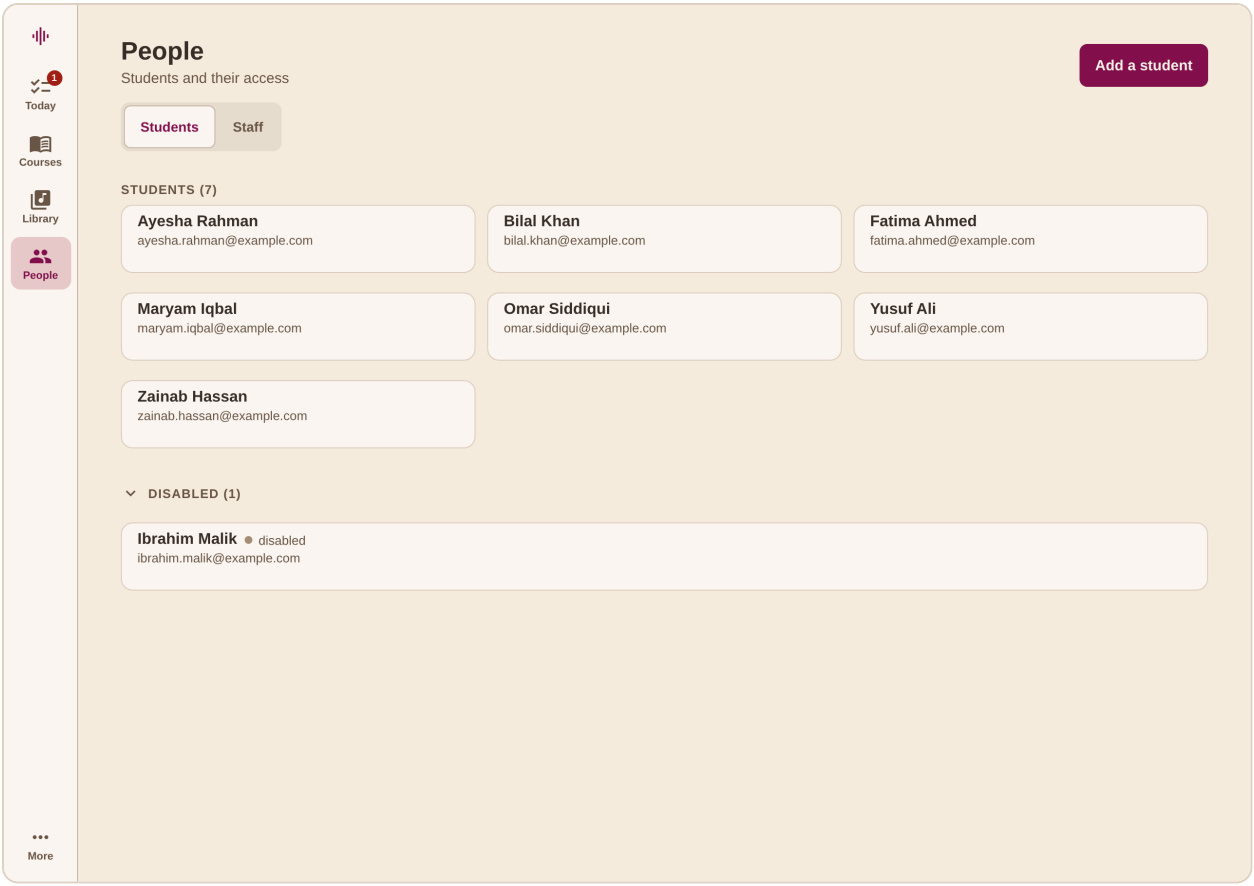
The **library** is every recording you can see, across all your courses, in one list — with a count summary and filters for **published / draft / archived / unpublished / needs attention**. It's the fastest way to answer "which recordings still need audio?" or "what's flagged?" without walking course by course. Admins see everything; managers see their assigned courses.

Two dropdowns narrow the list by where a recording belongs. Choose a **cohort** and leave the course alone to see everything in that term; choose a **course** as well to see just that course. The course list offers the courses in the cohort you chose — or every course, each with its term, when no cohort is chosen — and the count line describes whatever you have narrowed to. **Clear filters** appears whenever something is narrowing the list and puts everything back.

2.11 People — managing students



On a phone



On a computer

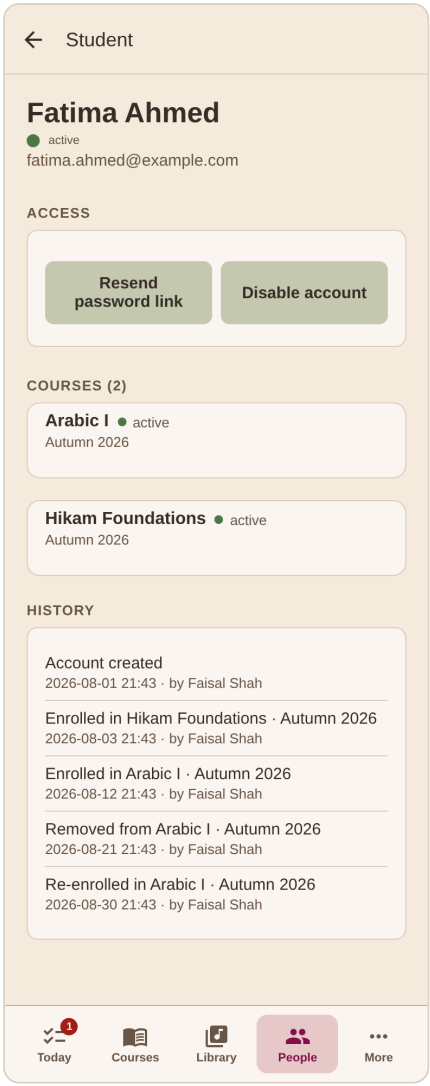
People holds both populations. Admins get a **Students / Staff** switch above the list; managers see the student directory and no switch, because approving staff isn't theirs to do. The directory is the whole institute for every staff member — a manager can look someone up before enrolling them, which they could not do if the list were cut to the courses they already run. What a manager cannot see is anyone's *progress* outside their own courses: open a student and the page shows only the courses that manager runs.

To add a student, tap **Add a student**, enter their **full name** and **email**, optionally **enrol them in a course** right away, and tap **Create account**. The app emails them a link to set their own password — you never handle passwords. The course list offers only courses that are running; an archived course, or one in an archived cohort, is not listed there (you can still enrol someone into it from the course's own page).

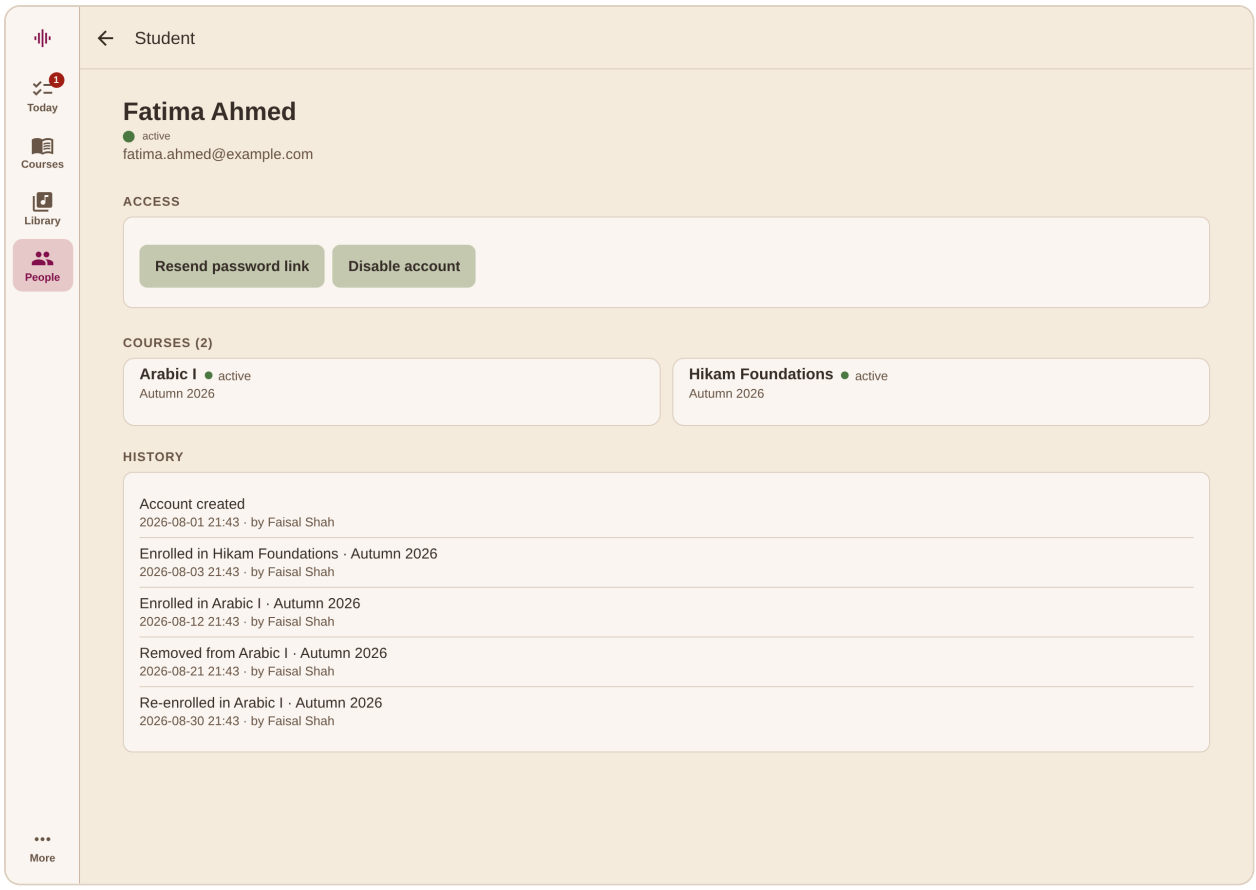
Creating accounts is done on the website, not in the phone apps. The **Add a student** button in the figures above is a capture of the website at a phone's width; in the Android app it is simply absent. This is a store requirement rather than a limitation we chose, and it only affects *creating* — changing roles, disabling an account and enrolling someone all work everywhere.

The list itself is just for finding someone. **Tap a student to open their page**, where everything about them lives. Students you've disabled move out of the main list into a **Disabled** section at the bottom — tap the heading to open it.

A student’s page



On a phone



On a computer

It shows their name, address and whether they're **active** or **disabled**, and carries three actions:

- **Export workbook** — one Excel file for this student across their courses (Section 2.13).
- **Resend password link** — if they lost the email or the link expired.
- **Disable account** — turns off access without deleting anything. (Disable, don't delete — deletion is a separate, deliberate, admin-only step.) Admins only; managers see the state but not the switch, because access spans every course.

Below that are **the courses they're in**. Tap one to open that student's listening progress for it.

If you're a **manager**, this lists the courses *you* manage — it's headed **Courses you manage** to say so. You aren't shown classes you don't run, so treat it as your view of the student rather than their whole record. An admin sees every course.

History, at the bottom, is the student's record from the day the account was created: when it was made and by whom, then every enrolment, removal and return, and every time the account was disabled or re-enabled — each with who did it and when, in the institute's time. It is read from the same audit history admins see (Section 3.3), so nothing here is a second record. A manager's list covers the courses they manage; account changes are admin-only, and an admin sees everything.

2.12 Notifications *(staff)*

Tap **More**, then **Notifications**. Managers get one message:

- **Attendance still not taken** — a couple of days after a class meeting whose attendance you never submitted.

It goes to the people who manage the class, so if you manage none — which is usual for an administrator — you have no switches here, and the screen says so. A session marked **not recorded** stops sending it.

It's more useful than it sounds. Until attendance is submitted nobody has been excused, so a recording you've already published is sitting there that not one student can open. **Today** shows the same thing in the app, with a count on the tab, so this message is a nudge rather than the only warning.

Reaching this device needs its permission as well. The app offers to set that up once, on Today after you sign in; you can also tap **Enable notifications** on this screen at any time. If it says they are blocked, use **Open settings** on a phone, or allow them from the site settings behind the icon in your browser's address bar.

2.13 Exporting a workbook

Two buttons produce every export the app has, and both make an **Excel workbook** — one `.xlsx` file with several tabs — rather than a flat list. On a phone the file goes to the share sheet, so you can send it to yourself or save it; on a computer it downloads.

Export workbook on a course page covers the whole course:

- **Summary** — the course's cohort, status and managers, the size of the roster, how many registers have been taken, the attendance and catch-up rates for the class, how much required listening is still open, and when the file was made and by whom.
- **Students** — one row per student: when they joined and left, their attendance counts and rate, and their catch-up on excused sessions — required, listened, still open, missed deadline, closed. Sorted so the students with the most missed deadlines are at the top. A **Note** column flags registers they were never marked on and completions that came from a staff override.

- **Sessions** — one row per meeting: when its register was taken and the marks on it, the recording's status, when it was published and its listen-by date, and how the excused students have done with it. A recording that has been archived or unpublished is noted as *withdrawn from the totals*.
- **Register** — students down the side, sessions across the top, one mark in each cell: **P**, **A**, **E**, a dot for a register never taken, a dash for a session outside the time the student was enrolled.
- **Listening** — the same grid for published recordings: whether each excused student listened (and when), or is still open, missed the deadline, or was closed — with how much of the recording they have heard.
- **Detail** — every required listening as its own row, with heard, last listened, completed at, and any override with its reason. This is the ledger of Section 2.6 for the whole course; filter it in Excel.
- **Definitions** — what every term in the file means, so the workbook explains itself to whoever you send it to.

Export workbook on a student's page covers one person across courses:

- **Summary** — their account, how many courses they are in, and their attendance and catch-up totals across all of them.
- **Courses** — one row per course, with the same enrolment, attendance and catch-up columns the course workbook gives each student.
- **Sessions** — every meeting in the time they were enrolled, in date order across courses, with their mark and — if excused — the recording's listen-by date and outcome.
- **Listening** — every recording they were required to listen to, with the evidence behind it.
- **History** — their record from the day the account was created: enrolments, removals and returns, account changes — each with who did it and when. It is the history the student's page shows (Section 2.11), plus the completion overrides the page leaves to each recording's ledger.
- **Definitions** — as above.

A manager's student workbook covers **the courses they manage**, and its Summary says so on the **Scope** line — the same view of the student their screens give. An admin's covers every course.

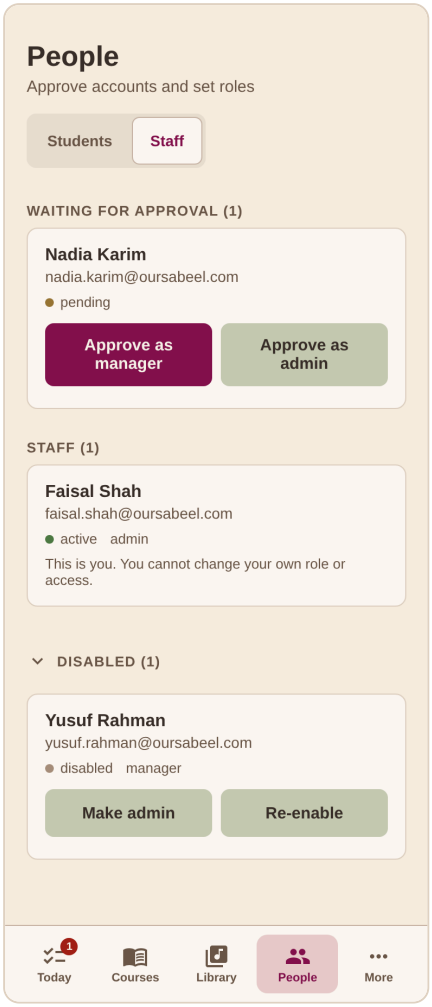
The file's **Definitions** tab reads:

Term	Meaning
Held	Registers submitted for sessions between the day the student joined the class and the day they left it, in which they were marked. A session whose register was never taken is not held for anyone.
Present / Absent / Excused	The mark on the register. Excused is the only mark that opens the recording and requires listening.
Attendance rate	Present ÷ Held.
Required	Excused sessions whose recording is published — one recording the student must listen to, by its listen-by date. A recording that has been archived or unpublished is withdrawn: it counts nowhere, and the Sessions tab says so.
Listened	The student marked the recording complete, or staff overrode it as complete (the override's reason is recorded).
Still open	Not yet listened, and the listen-by date has not passed.
Missed deadline	Not listened by the listen-by date. Access has closed; nothing further can happen to it unless the date is moved.
Closed	A required recording that was withdrawn from the student before its listen-by date: they left the class, or the class was archived with listening off. Neither listened nor missed.
Catch-up rate	Listened ÷ (Listened + Missed deadline). Open and closed items are not held against anyone.
Heard	Listening time as a share of the recording's length. Evidence, not the gate — completion is the student's own mark.
Times	Institute time (America/Chicago). Dates are real dates; sort and filter them in Excel.

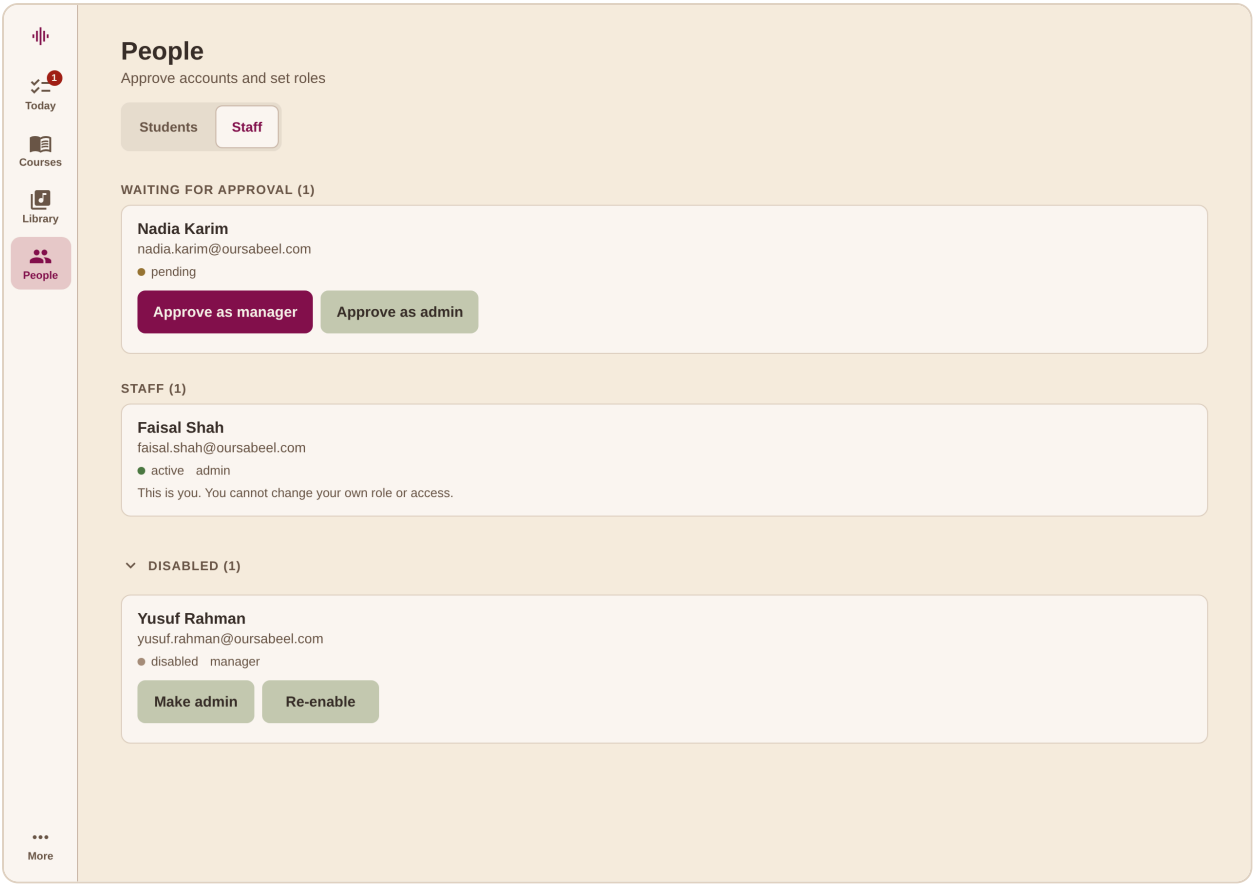
The columns hold real dates and real numbers, not text — so they sort, filter and add up in Excel. A rate shows a dash where there is nothing to divide by.

Part 3 — For admins

3.1 Approving staff



On a phone



On a computer

Open **People** and switch to **Staff**. New staff who sign in with Google land in **Waiting for approval**. For each, you choose the role as you approve:

- **Approve as manager** — they can run the courses you later assign to them.
- **Approve as admin** — full access, including approving other staff.

Below, **Staff** lists everyone with access. Your own account is marked “This is you” — you can’t change your own role or access, which stops an admin from accidentally locking themselves out. Staff you’ve disabled move out of that list into a **Disabled** section at the bottom, exactly as disabled students do — tap the heading to open it, and **Re-enable** is still on the card.

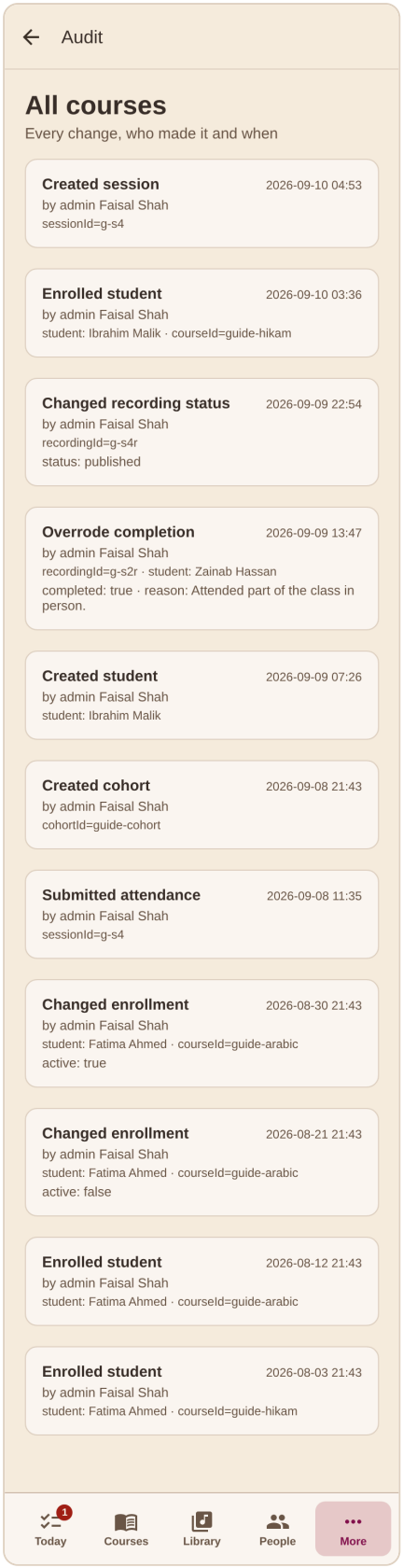
Only staff on the institute’s own Google domain can be approved at all — the app checks this on the server, not just in the browser.

3.2 Managers are scoped course by course

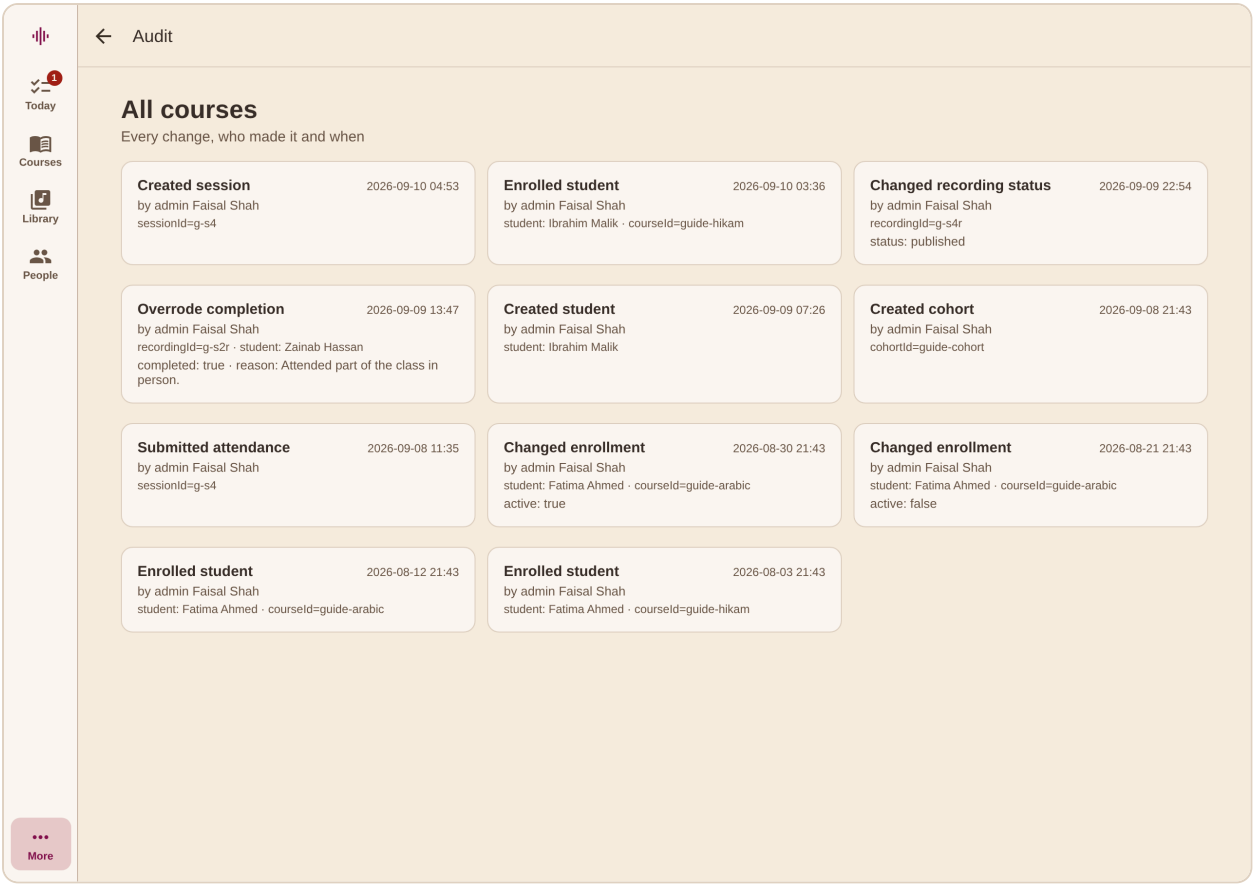
A manager can’t see anything until you give them a course. Do that on the **course page** (Section 2.3), under **Managers** — add them there, and they’ll see that course’s sessions, recordings, ledgers, attendance, and audit, and nothing else. Putting a course in a cohort a manager works in

does *not* grant access; the assignment is always the specific course.

3.3 The audit history



On a phone



On a computer

The **audit history** is the running record of consequential actions — staff approvals, attendance submissions, completion overrides (with their reasons), recording edits — newest first. Each entry shows *who* did *what*, *when*, and the details that matter.

You can reach it two ways: **globally** from **More → Audit history** (admins, all courses), or **scoped to one course** from that course's page (managers see their own courses' history). It's there so that "who marked this complete, and why?" always has an answer.

Times are the institute's, not your device's — the same clock as every **Listen by** date, so the two are comparable wherever you are reading from. The screen shows a fixed number of the most recent changes and says how many when it is full; nothing is deleted, and older history is still in the record.

3.4 Disable and archive — don't delete

The app is built around **reversible** actions:

- **Disable** a student or staff member to switch off access while keeping their history. It ends their session and stops reminders reaching their phone.

- **Unpublish** a recording to pull it from students without losing it, or **archive** it when it should stay closed. Both close it to the students who were excused and take it out of the course totals — its own listening progress page keeps the record; archiving is the one you reach for when nothing is wrong with the recording itself.
- **Archive** a course when a term ends — every count stays, and you decide whether students may still listen to it. This, not archiving its recordings, is how a term is closed.

Permanent deletion exists, but it’s deliberately admin-only, asks for strong confirmation, and is audited. Reach for disable, unpublish, or archive first.

Part 4 — “How do I…?” quick answers

I want to…	Do this
Listen to something I missed	**Listening** → tap the card → big round button.
Pick up where I left off	Just reopen it — your place is saved automatically, on any device.
Slow down or speed up	Tap **1×–2×** on the player.
Mark something done	Press play once, then **Mark complete** at the bottom of the player.
See my attendance for a class	**Classes** → tap the class.
Set my student password	Open the emailed link, or tap **Email me a password link** on sign-in.
Add a session *(staff)*	Course → **Sessions** → **Add a session** → title + date → **Create session**.
Take attendance *(staff)*	Session → mark Present / Absent / Excused → **Submit attendance**.
Add a recording *(staff)*	Open the session → **Upload audio…** (or import from Zoom).
Open a recording to students *(staff)*	Mark them **Excused**, then **Publish** — that is the whole of it.
Change the closing date *(staff)*	Session → **Edit session** → **Listen by**. Moving it forward reopens a closed recording.
See who’s behind *(staff)*	Session → **Listening progress** → **Not complete** / **Missed**.
Give someone credit anyway *(staff)*	Ledger → **Override** → reason (required) → **Mark complete**.
Make a latecomer catch up on an old session *(staff)*	Open that session → mark them **Excused** → **Submit attendance**. (Move **Listen by** forward first if it has passed.)
See course attendance *(staff)*	Course → **Attendance report** (toggle by session / by student).
Export a course for records *(staff)*	Course page → **Export workbook**.
Export one student’s record *(staff)*	**People** → the student → **Export workbook**.
Turn a notification off	**More** → **Notifications** → tap the one you don’t want.
Approve a new teacher *(admin)*	**People** → **Staff** → **Approve as manager / admin**.
Give a manager a course *(admin)*	Course page → **Managers** → add them.

I want to…	Do this
Create a student *(staff)*	On the website: **People** → **Add a student** → name + email → **Create account**.
See who changed what *(admin)*	**More** → **Audit history**.

Troubleshooting

I signed in but I'm stuck on an "approval" screen. *(Staff)* New accounts wait for an admin to approve them. The screen updates by itself the moment they do — no refresh needed. If you're stuck, contact your administrator.

A student can't sign in. Check the email address matches the one on their account exactly, then open their page from the People screen and use **Resend password link** so they can set a fresh password. New students have no password until they use that link.

The audio won't play. Streaming needs a working connection — try switching between Wi-Fi and mobile data. Play links refresh automatically, so simply reopening the recording usually clears a stale one.

A student says they shouldn't be on the hook for a recording. Check that session's attendance — required listening follows it. If they were there, mark them **Present** and re-submit; the obligation drops (and any listening they did is kept). If they genuinely missed it, that's exactly what the required listing is for.

I marked something complete but it still shows incomplete. If you were offline, the app is holding your mark and will sync it once you're back online; it may briefly show as pending. If a *teacher* has overridden your status, their mark takes precedence — that's by design.

A manager can't see a course. Managers only see courses they're assigned to. An admin adds them under **Managers** on the specific course page — being in the cohort isn't enough.

Where did a recording go? It may have been **unpublished** (back to draft) or its course **archived**. Both are reversible — check the session or the course settings. If the session's **Listen by** date has passed, move it forward before publishing again; the card on the session says so.